Shift

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/42293379.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warnings:
Rape/Non-Con, Underage Sex

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra), Kyle/Lonnie/Rogelio (She-Ra), Adora & Lonnie (She-ra), Catra & Lonnie (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Kyle & Lonnie & Rogelio (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Shift

by Rarissime

Summary

Adora hates her life, that until a brunette with parental issues walks into her life. She promises she wont get attached until...

The start

Thursday, - Store 128990

20:56

|| Chapter One ||

Adora was never fond of front, she would rather be on dt cash, or orders. But when the Manager asks Adora if she wants to be in front or dt drinks, she almost cries, but keeping her composure she just huffs out a quick, “Whatever Lonnie doesn’t wanna do, i’ll do.”

Lonnie raises her eyebrows in bafflement, but doesn’t say anything, “Drinks.” She mutters, walking away. She didn’t want to do drinks, but didn’t have the social battery tonight to deal with the people who came to front, plus Adora was baking and couldn’t do drinks and bake, front would be better for her Lonnie thinks.

Adora just nods, also not having the pure motivation to say anything to make her manager move her, it’s only her, Lonnie and Kyle tonight, no bakers, or break floaters, so they’re obviously fucked.

She watches as the night staff leaves, that was fine, they still had Imain till 3, and Kyle was leaving at 4, so they wouldn’t have too much work to do. (Yes they would)

Adora finishes up the last of the coffees for front, frowning at how *slow* the time is going, almost wondering if the clock was paused, of course not she thinks in her head, giving the small iced coffee out.

"Adora!" She hears Kyle call, and she turns looking at him, giving him a nod, "Do we have any Bread left?" He points at the headset he hands on.

Adora sighed, "Yeah, they're all in stock." She grabbed a bag, placed it into a bag before bringing it into dt, walking away and going to check the chicken that was cooking in the oven.

Adora wasn't in the mood for this dumb job, she was *exhausted* tired of this repeated routine she does everyday, she takes the chicken out, still watching for customers, she knows Lonnie or Kyle would call her if there was something they needed, there was three staff for dt, and for breaks Adora would be fine with running.

School wasn't too bad either. She did her classes and then at 10pm she made it to her shift, Lonnie normally worked 7pm, to 3am, but this week she was on for 9pm to 6am all week, Adora wasn't bothered to care, Kyle normally worked 8-4, but everything was fucked this week.

Adora looks at the time, it's 10 to 2, and she needs to start breaks. Washing her hands she checks the camera, it wasn't too busy, rush now finishing, she didn't get called for help, hopefully they don't hate her for not helping. She brings a tray of soft

cinnamon oat marshmallow cookies bars placing them into the display.

“Who wants their break first?” She addresses her co-workers, bringing out the cash. Imain was leaving in an hour, so she had to do this before Imain left. She looks between Lonnie and Kyle waiting for one of them to speak up.

“I’ll go,” Kyle repostes, taking off his headset and handing it to Adora, she smiles at him before placing it on her head, checking the battery life.

“You know we have like 3 chicken pieces left?” Imain comments, trying to pick on the blonde, it obviously doesn't work Adora just pointing away and into the kitchen.

Adora finishes up taking some orders making sure everything was correct and checking the stalklife of most of the food, because of course she was baking and covering for breaks.

Adora then hears the bell ring in front, she makes her way over, Making sure Lonnie and Imain were fine before doing so.

“Large black.” The man entails, she just starts it, not wanting to talk to this man at all, she takes his change then hands the large black.

" 'Dora, can you open the till, this guy wants change." She hears Lonnie say over the speaker, and how she was busy making more bread before Imain complains again.

"Cards there." She says over the headset, Kyle gives her a funny look, not pressing anything further, continuing to cut the bread.

Imain leaves at 3, leaving just Lonnie, Kyle and Adora. Making them short staff as always, she doesn't even care anymore as long as it's not just her, two people are fine.

"Adora, have you counted the safe yet?" Kyle's assets, Kyle being supervisor, didn't know why she had to do it, but knew it needed to be done, she just nodded, going back to counting the floats.

Kyle leans over her shoulder watching as she counts the nickels, he starts to count with her, watching how fast she does it, almost going too fast for him, she huffs finishing the cash writing down the total, "It's short 6:50." She notes, going to zip it up.

"Watch the hashbrowns, I'm going to count the safe." Adora pests, walking out to the floor going to get her keys, she watches Lonnie who was writing something on a page, probably school work, and Adora wasn't going to say anything about it, not like Lonnie had customers.

"I'm just going to count the safe, i'll keep the headset on, call me if you need help." She breathers her way out and into the back,

going to unlock the safe, and the float cabin.

She starts to count the safe, writing down the numbers onto a blue sticky note, knowing that the last staff forgot to do the safe, and knowing that there's way more than she thought.

"...Adora there's Karen."

She places the stick note down along with the pen, she locks back the safe, telling Lonnie that she would be there soon, and if the line was long tell the person to come inside and Adora would speak to her.

Lonnie replies back, a quick, "She's coming in, because I can't stand their face."

"Ok. Is it busy out there?" Adora asks, and she doesn't remember hearing a lot of people taking orders, just a few, and she knew that there wasn't anyone in front. Adora places her keys on the belt, walking out and into the front.

"Is something happening out front?" Kyle questions, placing the food he ate on break, punching himself back in.

"Yeah, basic Karen, or- urm, Ken?" She doubts herself because she wasn't really sure who the person was, just knowing that Lonnie sounded stressed, and Adora didn't like it.

“Ah, cool. Cool.” Kyle nods, walking beside Adora, and out onto the floor, he can now see the man waiting, hands crossed over his chest, mad snarl on his face, and he could see Adora gulp.

“Take this to Lonnie,” Adora hands Kyle her keycard, knowing that it’s more important to Lonnie, since it would take more work for her to look for the key, then Adora having to stop what she's doing to bring it to Lonnie.

Adora walks over to the man frowning intently, her arms also crossed around her chest, “How can I help you?” She contentedly says, calm, cool, collected.

“You're the supervisor here?” He looks Adora up and down, moving in a little closer cornering into a wall.

“Yeah.” she shrugs, “What was the problem?” Huffing, she checks the time, 10 to 3, Kyle needs to leave soon, and Adora needs to finish with this man.

“I want a manager! Not a stuck up child who doesn’t even know what they're talking about!” He yells more loud, and Adora was almost scared he would wake up the town.

“Listen, I get that, and if you would like to talk to the manager tomorrow morning, I can set that up, but right now, the manager

is out, and will be back at 6 tomorrow. Would you like me to text him?” Adora assures the situation, burning out the flame in the man's eyes.

“Just tell your co-worker to pay attention to their work.” He huffs, walking away, Adora shoots a text to their manager, and brushes off how close that man was towards her.

She walks back over to the dt telling Kyle that he may leave, knowing that it's 3 and time for him to leave. Lonnie and Adora wave him goodbyes, wishing him goodnight.

“Whatcha working on?” Adora remarks leaning over the counter, chin resting on her wrist. This is what the man was talking about, Adora knows how people don’t really enjoy when the workers are doing other stuff, but Lonnie would just sit there and do nothing so it was fine, Adora is fine with it and she’s the head supervisor tonight.

Lonnie flusters, looking up from the page dropping her pen, watching the cameras, “Just schoolwork.” She replies, “I’ll put it away if it’ll cause problems.”

“Honestly. I don't care,” She pats Lonnie's head, “I do it too.”

Lonnie smiles back, picking back up her pen and going back to the history work. A car shows up and Adora takes the order, then

going to start the drink, not wanting to make Lonnie do too much work since she had been on dt alone for way too long.

Lonnie and Adora had been friends since they could remember, being in the ohpanged together, (Kyle was there too, but they choose to ignore that fact) they learned to only trust each other, not even that, they just mostly looked out for each other after they moved out.

Adora should've been adopted honestly Lonnie doesn't understand why she wasn't, Adora's blonde and skinny, blue eyes, cute little red cheeks. Nothing like Lonnie.

"Adora… did you, uh-" Lonnie stops herself, not knowing how to ask this question, her and Adora have never really talked about this, she doesn't know how to bring this subject up.

Adora looks over at Lonnie, soft gester, "Mh, Lonnie?"

"I just, did you do something to not get adopted back.. You know," Lonnie sputters, and Adora never has heard her be unsure, and she thinks it may be because Lonnies tired, but still, what's with the weird questions?

Adora huffs, and Lonnie only looks up at her now, "I, um, I'm a brat." Adora replies looking at the order screen, distracting herself, she doesn't really want to have this conversation right now, but she can't really say she doesn't want to talk about this.

Lonnie slaps her shoulder, “You dumbass.” She counters, “You’re not a brat, and you never were.”

“Maybe,” She complains.

“Sorry, I didn’t- er, I shouldn’t have brought this up, we're both too tired for this.” Lonnie, watches Adora seeing as she calms, she goes back to her school work deciding that this conversation is planned for another time.

“It’s fine, did you want to talk about it?” Adora asks,she watches Lonnie, but looks away quickly when they’re was a car, glad that the shift was almost over.

The shift ends with the Morning baker coming in at 4, and Adora and Lonnie leaving at 6, after the 5 am staff comes in, leaving and getting ready for school.

Adora walks into her next shift, planning the night. Adora knows Lonnie, her and Imain are working, Imain only till 12, leaving early, and Lonnies only leaving at 4, and someones coming in at 5, so she’s alone for an hour.

“Adora, hello.” Her manager (Gorde) says, no emotion, just words. And Adora nods walking over and into his office, knowing that he

wants to talk by the tone of his cold voice.

“Did you need to tell me anything?” She questions, standing by the door, hoping nobody else is leaving early.

“There's a new person arriving soon, you’ll be training her.” He replies, and Adora just nods, asking about where she’ll be working today, and he tells her front, and that there is back in today so she won't have to bake, just training which is so annoying.

Adora grabs a cash, he tells her the new person will be here for quarter after 10, so she’ll have to prepare, not knowing how to train someone, also not knowing the name.

She had counted this cash last night so she wasn’t worried about it being short, she just didn’t pick any that were short, this reminds her that she needs to tell her manager that 3 were short out of the 5.

Her manager finishes counting the cashes, going to leave. He does confirm that yes they were short and that he fixed the problem, she places her cash into the front, telling the person that was working cash that they could leave and go home.

Lonnie greets Adora smiling softly to see her friend come in, and Adora smiles back, following the new girl into the backroom.

“It’s nice to meet you, I’ll be training you.” Adora watches as the girl looks around, multi-coloured eyes waving around the breakroom, and the other doors to other rooms, Adora doesn’t wait for her answer, going to show her were her locker.

“Erm, Hi,” The girl gives back, tying her brown wavy hair into a small bun, frizz seeming out, the girl places on the hair net over her head and then placing on the hat, leaving the bun out, now Adora’s not one to stare, but the girl was so fucking hot.

Long slender fingers tucking her hair into a low bun, nails nicely filed down, sharp and black. Her eyes focused on Adora before she looked away, smelling the soft cookies that were cooking in the oven, “My names Catra by the way.”

“We’ll be in front today.” The blonde replies, nodding, and Catra now can see how, tired this women looked, she had the facial structures s of someone as cara's age, and it doesn’t fit right in her stomach, the manager said the person that was training her was very experience, and had worked here for awhile, but this girl was so *young.*

Catra wouldn’t lie, the girl had a gorgeous defined jawline, straight soft teeth, and her plump luscious lips. They look so nice to– she has to stop herself turning around and over to her cubby staring at her hands.

This would be a *Nightmare.* Catra is so fucked

Learning

Chapter Summary

Adora trains Catra.

Saturday, - Store 128990

00:32

|| Chapter Two. ||

Catra hadn't known how difficalts a Friday would be, she saw like 9 drunks come in and yell at blondie, and the fact that she had told Catra that this was slow, overstaffed, and calm made her chuckle.

Catra just stood there, well that was until the baker came in saying that Catra needed to do more work, and she swears it made adora *mad,* and she feels like they don’t like each other. She gives Adora a look, and Adora gives back a frown shooing look back.

Adora tells her that she can do the drinks, Adora helping of course, teaching her what to do even though Adora herself is busy with customers, they both watch the night baker leave, Adora says that he mostly leaves around 11 but had to stay late for the deposits since Adora said she wasn’t doing it.

The line calms down after a bit, Adora and Catra go take a water break, “Is it always that busy?” Catra yawns looking at the clock, it was still so early in the night barely hitting the morning, she watches Adora at the sliver of water that dribbles down her chin, she hastily wipes the water placing down the water bottle.

They go back onto the floor, cleaning up and helping dt, also adora showing Catra the ropes, showing her what to do and how to do it, even showing her how to take orders, of course not forcing her, just showing.

Lonnie gives Catra a more stern look, but digaring and going back to her work. Catra looks at Adora’s blank face, checking the time, she turns walking over to Lonnie, muttering something, and Catra doesn’t listen in not caring enough.

Lonnie then nods, before walking away, and into the break room, Catra looks at the other staff; they were all unfazed by how Lonnie walks off, going away.

Catra learns that she was actually going on break, she shrugs deciding that she deserved it, she was overworked.

The rest of the night goes by very smoothly, almost too smoothly, nevertheless, the early staff leaves, leaving Adora and Catra left, Catra likes to say she’s good at picking up people's emotions?? She doesn’t really know (Maybe it’s a vibe thing?) She can just tell that the girl in front of her is so mentally and physically tired. Possibly Emotionally too, anyways it’s the blonde's problem, not Catra’s.

Adora can tell that the new girl is staring at her, maybe that’s just her thing, Adora doesn’t mind too much, she’s way too busy.

“Mh, what was your name again?” Catra softens her old on the cup she was stalking into place. Watching the blonde give her a dirty look.

“Adora.” Adora replies, placing the last of the lid sleeve into the drawer, closing it then walking over to the thick haired girl.

“Um, ok, so what did you want me to do?” Catra counters back to were Adora was standing, and of course this was her first day, but she wasn't dumb and knew that the tall blonde needed help.

Adora hums, telling Catra to follow her, and. Catra groans but doesn't complain, Adora brings her to the kitchen, bringing her to the counter there's some buckets, a strainer, and a bag of sugar.

“Can you strain some sugar? I have to write down tomorrow morning's positions, call me if you need anything, and there's cups over there!” Adora says walking out picking up a clipboard, and Catra just goes reading the page that explains what to do, also it’s common sense.

Adora goes over to right he positions from the note the manager left her, putting them onto the board, finishing that she goes to

check on Catra watching how she does the sugar.

Adora yawns, checking the note that the manager sent her. She sees that the lemonade needed to be made along with the cold brew. She decides to make the harder one first.

Catra finishes sugar going to watch Adora brew cold brew pretty efficiently making it quick and easy.

Adora firmly places the lid onto the cold brew jug, placing it into the brewing spot, checking the note again and going back onto the floor, watching out for customers.

“Hey Adora?” Catra starts and Adora realises that the new girl had said her name, Adora hums and Catra counties, “Do you enjoy working here? Or is this like- a erm, I dunno, a nightmare?”

“It’s okay.” Adora replies, and she’s picking up the Cold Brew and bringing it out to the fridge before the morning staff come and bring it out, it’s around 15 to five, she knows the line will pick up around 5 maybe, but since it’s sunday, it’ll be slower till 9.

Adora’s muscles flex as she brings the heavy can of cold brew making Catra blush before looking back down at the sugar, trying to not look at the way Adora looks so nice and this job is just breaking her.

Once the sugar is done, Catra and Adora make lemonade, making sure to put stickers on the Sugar, Lemonade, and cold brew, making sure they're fresh, Adora starts brewing the Decaf iced coffee, puting the sticker on that as well.

Adora looks at the time frowning if a rush was to start she would end up working overtime, she almost doesn't want to do it, but she's off tomorrow and she knows she'll be in shit if she skips out on it for two days, since she knows her cover won't

She sees the Morning staff coming in and she smiles checking off the finished things she did. She watches the baker come in and just gives him a dirty look before grabbing her cash and bringing it into the office so she can count it,

"You're not leaving?" Catra almost frowns, but she keeps a level face, watching Adora write something on a page her hair was out now, her normal bun was out and in a loose ponytail starting to fall fly hairs crowning her face.

"Nah, I'll have to hang back since I have a few things to do, but you're good to go." Adora replies, and she doesn't look up from her work, hands moving fastly at the papers wanting to go home too, and the brown haired girl just shrugs, turning and walking away.

Adora's day off

Chapter Summary

Adora is a bit sad ;<

Sunday, - Store 128990

08:10

|| Chapter Three. ||

Adora was off today. And she was so tired, she normally had Saturdays off, only coming in she'll be back Sunday night, and it was like this every week, she worked 6 days, then had Saturdays off, easy of course. She hated it.

She gets up out of her bed, she didn't get much sleep after only leaving at 6, and its exhausting but hey, it's her fault she's too slow, and if she was faster she would not be there as long. She hears a small meow at her door so she gets up letting Mara come in and watch her.

"Good morning Mara." She yawns, stretching her shoulder before standing up and petting the small white cat. She goes into the kitchen, starting Mara's food, the cat sits wagging her tail.

Adora lived in a small apartment, not wanting a roommate she got a small one that she could afford. She was tired of the foster

parents she was tied to so she left, not seeing them again,

When she first got to the apartment,she was walking home from work, (this was around the time before she got her car) she saw a little scrawny cat, crying by a dumpster, so of course benign the great person she is, she picks up the cat bringing it under her care.

Adora never plans anything on Saturdays, being way too tired to actually do anything, once and while Bow or Glimmer would come over, maybe even Lonnie, but hey she decided that they could come *any other day* she's just so tired.

Fancy annoying people.

[Glim:]: Adooora

Sent 10:23

[Bow]: Is sleeping glim.

[Glim]: Boring who's always busy on a Saturday anyways!?

[Bow]: Adora obiv.

[glim]: whatever :(

Adora ends up sleeping all day, until Lonnie comes over, (she has a key.) she chooses not to wake the blonde up, just coming because she was bored, she normally does a lot less hours then Adora, grateful that she got good adopted parents.

“Hey Mara,” SHe crouches down petting the cat's head, the cat meowls, yawning and stretching out, Lonnie looks around seeing as the place is clean, “How’s Adora Mara?” She asks knowing that the cat will not answer, but this cat is very social, meowing and always being around, it surprises Lonnie.

Lonnie hears when Adora wakes up, when she does she comes out, not acting surprised to see the tanned girl just going to make some coffee, watching Lonnie stand, Adora makes her some too.

“You Alright, Lonnie?” Adora asks, voice is still tired with sleep still, and she looks refreshed at least. Lonnie sighs leaning her head on the counter, why was Adora such a *people* person.

“Just didn’t want to be around them, you know?” She replies her head never rises and Adora frowns. Not knowing the feeling at all, she opens her mouth but Lonnie does first. “I mean, -no, you don’t know, I’m sorry. Gods, Adora. I-”

“It’s okay.” Adora replies, and she's smiling when Lonnie looks back up at her, eyes scanning the room, she tries to mask her beating heart, geeze she came here to see if Adora was ok, not to have a panic attack, gods she's a shit friend.

“It’s not.” Lonnie says bitterly.

Adora waves her hands, stress reaching her features, and normally she would hde it better, but Lonnie’s the ideal thing to think about, “Really, I gave you a key for this reason.” Adora starts, sighing softly, “No, I don’t know what you mean, and of course I feel jealous, but that doesn’t make you burden me.”

And Lonnie feels bad again, but she understands what Adora’s saying, she could probably be a better friend, or even be better to herself.

“If you need to rant, go ahead.” Adora now says she's handing Lonnie the coffee and god Lonnie couldn’t ask for a better friend.

And Lonnie does, she rants, and Adora listens, and Adora’s always been good at listening, always was back at the horde, they end up on the couch, Lonnie was cuddling with Mara, and Adora was working at school Lonnie doesn’t really know.

“Adora?” Lonnie utters, and Adora doesn’t look up continuing to work on whatever she was doing, she does hum, maybe thinking Lonnie wants to rant more, but if that was the case she would have given Lonnie her full attention, just in case.

“You can rant to me, you know. I’m here too.” Adora looks at her, her face blank, eyes sinking to Lonnie's hands, then she smiles giving a soft nod.

“Of course. I trust you.” Adora replies, hands drifting back to the small cat, and Lonnie’s hands. It confuses her *why is she so interested in my hands,* Lonnie thinks, shs doesn't want to let this one slide.

“Adora.” Lonnie says again, it's firm, and it makes the girl look back up from the work, giving Lonnie a soft smile. Lonnie can tell it's so fake. She hates it.

“Yes Lonnie?”

“Your hands are shaking.” Lonnie repeats it, its soft caring, and it makes Adora startle cause when is Lonnie this nice? And right after seeing her almost cry. Adora thinks she would close up, Adora would.

“Have you eaten today?” Lonnie asks, and she’s trying so hard to be patient. Trying to calm the anger that is gaining in her chest. She’s not mad, Never mad at Adora.

Adora looks guilty at the floor. No she didn't, but has Lonnie, probably not. So why does it matter? She utters a voice so small, “Have you?”

“Before I came.” Lonnie replies and she's not looking gently petting the cat, anything, “And you?”

“I.. haven't” there's a gap in between her words, she’s trying.

“When is the last time you have?” Lonnie's anger is searing into worry, because it looks like Adora’s *actually thinking.*

“I.. think yesterday, maybe.” Lonnie moves an inch closer, seething at how Adora looks so scared, *is this her fault.*

“Would you like me to make you something? I’ll leave you alone after. I’ll leave if you would like.” Lonnie’s really trying to be gentle, honestly she's at a loss.

And she nods, of course she nods, she wants to be alone Lonnie can tell, and they're not even close, she feels they need to be closer.

Lonnie makes something small, she really doesn't think Adora has a big appetite, when she comes back with the food, Adora’s sitting staring unblinking at the floor, rubbing the cat monotonously.

She watches for a while, she's about to call Kyle at this point cause she has no clue what to do, but she doesn', she just bends

down trying to get the girls attention, she's digging so deep in her brain going back to when they were kids when this would happen more often than not.

Then in a flash Adora’s head is on Lonnie’s shoulder, and Lonnie’s so glad she came today, she touches Adora’s back, the girl tenses pushing deeper into the shoulder.

“Ok. Thats fine.” Lonnie says, and she hates contact so much, absolutely hates it, but it’s Adora. She can’t say no to Adora.

Adora cries not for long, trying to breath a lot deeper, it gets to the point of Lonnie having to grab her arm and place it on her own chest, breathing even deeper for the blonde to catch up on, lucky it works calming the girl down,

“I- I’m sorry!!” Adora’s backing away, and it breaks Lonnie’s heart, cause Adora knows how much she hates contact, and thats the only reason why Adora’s apologising.

“.. It’s okay, I'm serious. I don’t mind contact that isn't pain.” And Adora’s looking up nodding too tired to care, all she wants to do is sleep, Lonnie gets it.

Lonnie decides that she actually wants to stay the night, of course Adora says sure before letting her, it's almost 3 am now, and Adora’s about to sleep, she replies to her fancy friends.

[Ad]: Sorry I slept all day!! •.•

They were of course not up.

Adora goes back to work sunday, her and Kyle were working both supervisors and knowing what to do, not having to talk just working in silent or their own music while watching out DT or front, they had talked and told each other what the other would do after 4 when it was just them too, so there would be no confusing.

They finish early both being fast at almost everything while serving customers, and the baker comes in, as Adora's doing the safe count, and making sure its all correct, making sure the tills were in line, Kyle comes back saying that the stalk was done, before watching her tiredly yawning.

"It's alright if I leave?" He asks, he would never just leave without her consent, but they had finished everything and if Adora needed help he would stay back. But of course she just said it was fine, and he was gone.

She updated the position chart before she heads out, updating the morning staff, and clocking out and leaving.

not ok

Chapter Summary

Adora is trying, she swears.

Monday, - Store 128990

19:32

|| Chapter Four. ||

Catra was in earlier today, something about how the night staff needed more help, she's not sure. She knows she's leaving at 4, coming at 8 instead of 9.

It wasn’t weird, honestly she knew the people, even though they were stange, but she was fine with it.

She normally didn't go to school, it was so much work after a shift, she wonders how Lonnie and Adora do it, but she shows up when she wants to, most of the time it's never.

She’s gotten really better at everything, knowing that she's a fast learner anyways.

Catra is on drinks, she looks up at Lonnie, who was dazily taking a order, goofily telling them to drive up, and she almost feels bad, she doesn't because Lonnie gives her a dirty look, making Catra embarrassed and looking away

Once the line calms down, it's around 8:30 and she knows Adoras is coming in, she doesn’t care, she knows Kyles coming in too, at least the morning staff will have everything ready. Knowing that there honestly too of the best workers that do AM shifts.

Adora comes in around 8:40, she watches Kyle count the tips for the other staff, she doesn’t say anything, Kyle will understand she hopes, he finishes by putting Adora and his box down, names nicely written by Lonnie. Kyle does understand, he’ll never not understand, he gets it he guesses, it hasn’t been this bad in a while though.

“I’ll go on food today, the shift would go faster.” He exhales a breath. He's not looking at Adora, he doesn’t want her to think he’s doing this to pity her, he’s not. But her thoughts don’t ever let her rest, so he tries.

He thinks she would say at least something, but she just hums, walking over to the floats. And he just frowns, walking off, he wonders if he did the right thing, maybe food won't even be busy, he’d feel bad if that was the case.

“Adora’s not out first i’m shocked.” Lonnie snickers, she’s in front, and is leaving at 3 she seems on edge, he remembers her saying she doesn’t like front, being more on DT cash way more, Kyle does too.

“She’s counting the cash for the drive through, and we're both early anyway.” He replies, he remembers when he used to be scared of Lonnie, he grew out of that thankfully.

“Thought she was on food?” Lonnie asks, and her tone is less playful. Catra wasn't listening. She was overhearing.

“I'd rather.” He replies, and he’s walking away now, Lonnie going back to her customers.

Adora goes off to DT cash, she doesn't say anything, barely makes eye contact with anyone, just working quickly to finish the line, which is done by 11, which makes everyone calm a bit.

Lonnie comes over later, she just stands watching the blonde more closely. She doesn't notice anything off, she doesn't get how Kyle can just read her like that, she’s more closer with Adora anyway.

Catra gives her a look, and it makes her snarl, she doesn't like her at all, but she soon realises that she's *way* too close to Adora, she can feel how tense the girl was, she backs off before giving a more comforting smile.

Catra doesn't really know what to do, she can see how stressed the blonde is, it makes her realise that they're the same age, Catra wouldn't be able to have this much patience. She envies Adora.

“You missed one.” Adora is frowning, and Catra is quickly fixing her mistake, Adora hasn’t even talked to her, only the customers, and Adora always has a very soft customer service voice, not to razzle the customers, she doesn’t enjoy conflict, Catra gets that.

Catra fixes her mistake very quickly, not wanting to drag the angry customer on for longer. She doesn’t want Adora to stand and wait any longer than she would if someone else was doing it. She wonders for a while why Adora was on cash, she knows that Adora doesn’t enjoy doing nothing, always itching to do something, she mostly works Sandwich, almost never on cash.

Kyle mostly goes on cash, and she gets it if they want to switch. And yes Kyle is good at sandwiches, she never had said he wasn’t. She figures he doesn’t like it by how his face turns when he has to actually make something, after all that she knows Kyle was one sandwich yesterday.

She supposes that if they both decided to switch it’s because they both were tired of the positions they were on, Catra grows as she drops the lids on he floor, and Adora is not even paying attention just serving the customer they’re drinking, pressing the button once they leave, going on to the next.

Lonnie comes over later once her line clears, knowing that they needed help even though they would never admit it, she takes orders for a while, getting the baked goods too,

Catra realises that Kyle's being more of a boss today, which Catra would never see, (She thinks he sucks.) Adora usually bosses, but she's not today, maybe it's her mood. Adora wasn't feeling well today.

Kyle sends Lonnie home, she leaves so quickly before anyone can say bye, Catra gets it, she's probably tired, and anyways she doesn't have time to care. Kyle sends Catra on break, and Adora knows it's late, she does she would have sent her way earlier, she supposes it's her fault, she'll have to apologise sometime.

Adora's cleaning up the receipts from the night staff, sighing at her having to do it when she's well aware the night staff are supposed to, she hates that she has to do this or she'll be in trouble. She's writing these things, while the night staff gets to live peacefully.

Kyle's stocking the sandwich, even though it was not stocked for him, he has no choice it has to be stocked or the morning staff will complain, Kyle and any of the AM staff have never complained, he thinks it very unfair but whatever. He knows he's very late on breaks, but he figures it's fine, if Catra wanted a break she would've opened her mouth.

Kyle hears the phone while he's grabbing wrap and biscuits from the freezer, Catra looks up from her phone, looking at him with those two different coloured eyes, she goes back to her phone rather quickly going back to her phone, Kyle walks over to the phone going to answer,

“[Store name] Lorewalk, How may I assist you?” He says, and cringes at how he can hear a car rolling through the Drive-through, the person is really drawing out this call.

“Is there a manager in?” The person replies, they sound so angry and it makes the blonde shiver.

“They’ll be in a 6. It’s 3.” He resorts, trying.

“Would you have their number?” The person is really creeping the boy out, and he can hear Adora taking a order from the side of the headset.

“I can’t give out his personal information.” Kyle sighs, he’s way too busy for this.

“Why not?” This person was really irritating the poor boy. This is the reason he never answers the phone.

“It’s mildly unprofessional, again, you may call at 6, they’ll be here then.” He’s trying really hard to not hang up.

“You’re useless.” The person hangs up, and he sighs going out to the front, he sees how clean it is, and how Adora’s writing stuff down he figures that Adora handle the customers,

“What was that about?” Adora’s voice is soft, and it's the first few words she has said to the blonde, he’s glad he answered the phone. Of course Adora could handle it but he can tell she’s not in the best mood.

Catra comes back from her break, she’s not sure what she's supposed to do, but it’s only a hour, Kyle looks at Adora, dull eyes looking at the screen, she looked so focused on nothing, it was upsetting Adora’s really never been this deep in her mind since they were little, and kyle doesn’t remember that.

“Just a customer looking for the manager.” Kyle replies to the girls question and she looks at him with soft eyes, searching for something.

“Oh.” The blonde replies, she looks back at the screen and he realises that she’s looking at past orders, her eyebrows furrow in angst. Kyle sighs.

Catra walks over, frowning, “Hey Adora.” She says, her voice was soft gently, she calmly looks at Kyle, Adora doesn’t move, Catra whispers, “Take her off the floor.”

Kyle stammers, because Carta's right, but before he can open his mouth to say anything, Adora's talking, muttering something, soft tones coming off her lush lips, “It’s 4, you should probably leave.”

“No. not if you're staying on the floor dissociation.” Catra’s not backing down, eyes dedicated to the poor blonde.

“That’s fine Catra, you can leave and Adora will go work on the back stuff, since that’s what we would do anyways.” Kyle says, and Catra nods walking to the back with the girl, gently taking off her headset and handing it to Kyle.

Catra and Adora haven’t known each other too long, but Catra understands that the girl has some deep rooted trauma, she understands, she wouldn’t say she’s a good person but she sees someone struggling she won't stand and do nothing.

“Thank you Catra.” Adora utters and she’s struggling, and Catra hates that look in her eyes, trying to think of anything to help the girl.

“Of course blondy, try not to get too deep in that head of yours.” Catra’s back to not being overly nice, more sarcastic and laid back, the girl counts the tips and then clock out and leaves.

Adora makes cold brew, lemonade and iced coffee, going to the safe, she checks the camera making sure it’s not too busy.

The shift ends at 6,, and Adora’s gone, not wanting to be here any longer, she says bye to Kyle apologising again before getting in her car and leaving.

Trusting

Chapter Summary

Catra knows Adora cares about her. But why?

Thursday, - Store 128990

17:29

|| Chapter Five. ||

Catra would never understand the feeling of hope, she had even up on it for a long while. She woke up, as she did every day, tired, lonely and utterly sad. She never really understood her feelings, she never wanted to either, they seemed completed, way too much for her right now.

Scorpia and her meet up when she gets to school, being happy that she didn't work last night, scopia seems more energized today. "Geez. Pushy today." Catra grumbles, walking over to her locker, she really was in a good mood today.

"You seem on edge today." Scorpia replies, she's leaning against the locker, arms crossed looking down at Catra, Catra hates that the white haired girl is taller, why'd she get the short stick.

"Tired." Catra is looking into her locker, digging around for a book or something, anything to not look at the taller girl. *Anything.*

“Anything else?” Scorpia isn’t looking at her, mostly at the other people she could socialise with, other people that aren’t Catra.

“No.” Catra utters, voice more stronger, and she slams her locker before walking off, scorpia is of course right behind her, would never leave her best friend.

“Just let me know then?” Scorpia is such an amazing friend, Catra hates that she’s so rude all the time, why she can’t stop.

“Ok.” Catra replies, walking off to their class, sitting down next to each other. Placing a airpod into her thick hair, knowing no teacher will see it under all that hair.

Catra comes home, she goes inside, not saying anything to her parents, she doesn’t care enough to actually do anything with them, she doesn’t enjoy being their child.

Ever since Catra was a child, she didn’t enjoy being around people, being scared of loudness, something wrong with her soul she presumes, she doesn’t remember much from her childhood, there was a lot of noise, (way too much). She remembers her parents, screaming, crying in agony, over money, smashing plates, flour, bowls, and cups because they were angry.

She does understand now, understands why her brother went away, (she wanted to leave too) she gets why she was questioned

at school by the police, teachers and the case worker, she understands the bad smells that were in the house, why it was always smokey. Really she gets it now.

Smoking was something that tore people apart. The first time her parents got into a huge fight over it, their neighbour was complaining about the smelly grey smoke coming from their windows. Everyone was yelling, it was so loud, and Catra hated every moment of it.

The police had come, arrested her dad for a while till he went onto parole, she knew her parents weren't supposed to be together, they told her to keep quiet to make sure no one finds out about her parents, about her family.

She never made friends, being too scared of anyone finding out, and telling the police, (She didn't want to see her mom sad again.) So she never made friends.

Scopia broke her walls quickly, (she's so friendly, and tall, and pretty.) Catra never opened up to her, never needed to, she remembers when scorpia had come out to her, she was proud, she even went to Scorpia's house, her parents were so nice, so supportive of their child.

Catra broke down that night.

On Catra’s 8th birthday she learned that her parents were bad people, and were not good at parenting, only caring about themselves and the money they make, she wanted a normal family, but was that possible.

Being a hopeless kid sucked.

Friday she went to work, so tired and of course she was staying till 5, along with Adora(Adora leaving at 6), hopefully it wasn’t too horrible, well not with Adora it wouldn’t be, she knows Adora’s pretty good at supervising, but the whole Lonnie thing is freaking her out.

Lonnie’s leaving at four, she thinks so it’ll be okay.

[Catra]: Would you be able to pick me up?

[Adora]: Of course, regular time?

Adora has been picking up Catra for awhile, she figures that Catra would text her, she is really fond of Catra, she has a tense presence. She ends up picking her up, and she can tell Catra’s a bit sad(?) in the car she doesn’t say anything, just driving them to the store.

They make it in, and Adora constaling the manager before she’s walking out giving Catra a cash for front, and Catra’s fine with that

she doesn’t mind front, and Adora’s bringing a cash for drive through, and that's how the night goes.

Adora and Lonnie talk for a while, and Catra’s fine with that cause she didn’t feel like talking anyways, so she was fine with stocking up and working with the small crowd of front customers.

Imain, was on food, which was annoying but she left at one, so Adora was doing food, and Catra was cool with that, Adora lets Lonnie leave at 3;30, which was fine, they were fine till 5 it wasn’t even busy, they just did the regular and when the morning staff came in they both left Adora driving catra home.

*

When Adora receives a text she always tries to answer it, feeling bad if she doesn’t,

[Catra]: R you vusy?

[Adora]: No, did u need anything?

[Catra]: could yit pick mr up?

And it’s unsettling, cause Catra’s usually really good at spelling, being good at receipts makes people do that, she feels like something bad happen.

[Adora]: Of course, do you know where you are?

[Catra]: [Linked address]

[Adora]: I’ll be there soon.

When Adora shows up, Catra’s holding herself so tightly while waiting for the blonde, she gets into the car, hands shakily buckling herself, Adora frowns because she looks so distressed, “Wou;d you like me to bring you home?” Adora asks, she's watching the road, not the shorter girl.

“No,” A small utterance came out of the girl, it was sluggish, slow. So she didn’t want to go home, Adora was going to bring her to Adora’s apartment but the girl spoke up again, “I don’t need to go to your house either.”

“Ok. Was there anywhere specific?” Adora makes a turn jostling the car, and when Catra doesn’t answer she stops at a park, it was empty and she decided that it was good enough for the shorter.

“Thanks Adora,” Catra sighs, and Adora thinks Catra believes that Adora’s leaving, and when she gets out of the car too Catra looks at her more confused.

“I’m not leaving you, not until you're safe,” Adora is following her and for some reason it makes the mult-coloured eye girl feel safe.

“Ok.” Catra replies, and she turns looking at the blonde, “Sorry for bugging you on your day off.” Catra’s looking down and Adora feels so guilty and she doesn’t understand why.

“It’s ok, thank you for trusting me.” Adora replies, she kneels next to Catra; who was huddling on to herself, sharp nails scratching parsline skin.

“I-” Catra’s gasping for air, only hearing static in her poor ears, trying anything to hear the blonde trying to help her,

Catra ends up in Adora’s arms, and Catra bitterly walks over to the swings, sitring down and kicking her feet in the sand, it was pretty late now, sunrise.

“Sorry, for um. That.”

“It’s okay. It’s normal.” Adora feels very tired, but she’s okay with that. She’ll sleep when she gets home.

“I’m okay now.”

Adora frowns, the two eyes look so sad, and Adora can see way too much of herself in them, she leans against the pool, arms crossed from the chilly morning air.

“I’m not leaving you.”

“Ok. My parents will be asleep soon, so you can take me home.” Catra looking down eyebrows furrowed, hiding in shame.

“Are you sure?” Adora’s a bit closer, Catra isn’t moving from her place, small shakes hitting her hands, she’s quick to hide the quivers, clenching her fists into small balls, fingernails digging into her palms.

“Catra.” Adora’s talking some more, and Catra wishes the girl would stop, but it’s Adora, Catra hums, words stuck in her throat.

“I’ll take you home now,” Adora utters, and Catra’s just noticing the blonde is squatting down in front of her, and it makes Catra feel short and sad. Adora gets up walking back to the car, waiting for Catra to make her way over, while calming herself down

She makes it to Catra's house, watching her walk off before driving off,

Confessions

Chapter Summary

Adora gets a text about the ticket raffle, who is she not to invite Catra?

Friday, - Store 128990

08:49

|| Chapter Six. ||

[Adora]: Feeling better today?

[Catra]: so so

[Adora]: Anything on your mind?

[Catra]: Just talk blondie.

[Adora]: ok

And Adora talks for awhile, she always typed very quick, Catra always liked that in people, And Catra doesn't expect Adora to get her out of the deep fog that is her head but she does.

She does.

[Adora]: That's not how it happen ://

[Catra]: Totally was

[Adora]: Not

[Catra]: Wtv

[Adora]: u working tonight?

[Catra]: at 7

[Adora]: o

[Catra]: Ur coming at 10?

[Adora] Yes

[Catra]: cya then

Read

When Adora comes in Catra's already in front, looking completely utterly stressed, and Adora feels bad, Kyle gives her a look before he goes over.

"You're good on sandwiches and front?" Kyle asks, he's grabbing the tips as they both walk to the office.

"Of course." Adora replies, grabbing they're tip cans and placing them next to the others, "I'll put the cash when Catra leaves." Of course she feels bad for the brunette but Catra needs to work until 4.

It was a horrible shift, too many customers for Catra's liking so much talking and running, it was so exhausting. Kyle comes out with cash, taking one of the night staff places.

The night goes smoothly and when they have no more customers, Catra's watching Adora, her deep eye bags, she looks so drained, and Catra honestly feels bad. The poor blonde.

"Adora," Lonnie requests, eyebrows furrowing in worry, and Catra agrees before going to count some coins not listening to the girls, she wouldn't want to bother them.

They talked for a bit, Catra didn’t mind seeing them work, she was still kinda upset about Saturday, still being tired, and more saggy, drained. But other than that Catra was fine.

Adora moves her Cash in dismissing Catra to go and count hers since the brunette was going to leave soon anyways, so why make her stay longer, it really benefits the girl, Adora sighs, not really wanting to be here at all, but hey, nothing she can do about it.

Adora gets a text half way through her shift, why is it always her. She sighs, grabbing her phone from her back pocket, Yes she had her phone on her, it was a safety measure for her and her staff.

[Gorde]: Hello Adora, was just wondering if you could come in at 8AM on monday?

[Adora]: Would have to check my schedule, was there a particular reason?

[Gorde]: it’s for the raffle, Dorin decided that she didn’t want to do it, you're my next best option.

[Adora]: 8 till?

[Gorde]: it would be till 6.

[Adora]: I probably could, would anyone else do it, or would it just be me?

[Gorde]: You may ask one of the staff to join you, of course.

[Adora]: Alright I let you know.

[Gorde]: Yes thank you Adora.

Adora sighs, placing her phone back into her back pocket, Kyle walks over after finishing his customer, it was later into the shift just him and her, and they both didn't really care. They both took turns baking, and making sure everything was ready for the morning baker. (She never liked him anyways)

"You're not one to text on the floor, something bothering you?" Kyle peeps, he startles her, being so quiet and small, Adora's hand is hovering over her back pocket.

"Manager." She replies, flat, and cold, it's nothing new, she's tired and so is he, they both understand, "It's for the raffle on tuesday." She comes up with a better explanation even though she knew that he understood.

“Would you like me to join, if Catra says no?” Kyle sees the blush rush to her cheeks, and she covers her face cowering. “Lonnie will say no.”

“Yeah,” She rubs her neck, softly sighing.

“I will, and anyways we’ll both work that night.”

“You’re right.”

“Always.”

Adora gets home and she texts Catra later, she really wants to do the raffle with Catra, but feeling bad, she knows Catra isn’t working that night, so it wouldn’t be that bad.

[Adora]; Hey

[Catra]: What

[Adora]: D:

[Catra]: Adora?

[Adora]; Catra :D

[Catra]: Ur so sufferble

[Adora]: Thats so mean

[Catra]: Ik

[Adora]; I wanna do the raffle w u

[Catra]: What’s that

[Adora]: the work one

[Catra]: the ticket thing that people r arguing ab it the group?

[Adora]; correct

[Catra]: Y

[Adora]: I dont wanna do it alone

[Catra]: ok

[Adora]; Will you

[Catra]: What

[Adora]: do the raffle w me

[Catra]: when

[Adora]; tuesday

[Catra]: time adora

[Adora]: 8 am

[Catra]: You're working that night?

[Adora]; Yea

[Catra]: Y would Gorde pick u

[Adora]: ok ouch

[Catra]: I mean like hourly wise

[Adora]; I did it last year

[Catra]: Oh ok then

[Adora]: So you'll do it?

[Catra]: Sure, if u pick me up

[Adora]: nfs

[Catra]: wtv cya.

Adora picks up Catra at 7;40, not that they would be late, but she didn't wanna be there to early, and of course she had to explain

everything to the shorter, making that a bigger chore then doing the raffles, also since everyone wanted to do it she felt bad.

"So how does this work?" Catra asks, and Adora smiles at her stupidity as she clocks in with her card, Catra followed clocking in and following her to the office, and the manager looks surprised Catra's here, maybe Adora never told him?

"Catra." He's looking at Adora while he says it, and he almost looks disappointed.

"Yes." Adora replies, in a proactive manner, and she just shrinks watching closely.

"The tickets are out, you can send Dorin in, and you may replace." He goes back to the computer, and writing stuff down, she darts her eyes away, when Adora tells her to follow.

"Would you like to write or talk?" And Catra's trying to read the girl, trying to see which one Adora wants to do, because Adora picked her, and seems completely selfless in this situation.

"If you would like, I'll talk, I'm much taller anyways, you might not even be able to reach the cars!" Adora, chuckles walking over to the drive through lanes, were the chairs, and cash was.

"Oh shut up."

“Adora!” Dorin calls, and Catra holds back a gag, not liking the girl at all, she shivers in disgust, pointing at the garbage bins as a cover as Adora rolls her eyes.

“Dorin,” Adora nods, walking over to see what the girl has done so far, and as Dorin explains, Catra gets the jis of what they will be doing, not like it’s supper hard anyways.

Dorin leaves, and Catra sits, they both do, and there talking to customers the both of them, both talking honestly the customers weren’t that bad, still Catra never liked them, Catra watched closely at Adora, she looked so amazing, like always, but seeing her smile while talking to the nicer customer while selling raffles, she looks so beautiful while she’s happy.

Her eyes, are so blue, and shiny, nose scrunching while she smiles, her hair was down, which was weird, but Catra guesses that she only puts it up for work, it’ sitting softly on her shoulders, it almost looks like Adora didn’t work last night, (which was barely a hour ago).

Catra’s writing names and numbers, and Adora’s handling money, which works perfectly, and the Blonde is so outstanding at it, everyone (almost) looks happy, while waiting in this very long line, and it makes the day go by pretty quick.

“You look good today,” One of the staff from the front had come out from the front, watching them, and he’s taller, staring at the

girl, and Adora's smile drops, as she hands the change from the customer, frowning slightly.

"Tokoyama." Adora replies, discarding his comment all together, she looks appalled by him, eyes not as happy as before she almost looks distressed.

"Aw, still mad?" He says, and Adora doesn't look mad at all, just going back to what she was doing, not paying attention to him at all, Catra wonders if the blonde would open up to her about whatever this is.

"Nah." Adora replies, and it takes her a while to say it, almost a few to minutes, and she's giving change back, and telling the brunette the name and number, and how many they bought as Catra writes it.

He leaves, and it takes so long, and Adora does look as happy, still gorgeous in Catra eyes, and she's still really nice to the people, the line was getting long, and everything was moving a bit quicker, and they could here the manager on the speaker, since they were pretty close, the people couldn't hear them (hopefully.)

"Things are going a bit quicker, so just write the number on the top corner, and place them in the float, i'll rewrite them later, or you can when the line calms." Adora sighs, then taking the next raffle order, "let me know if you want to switch."

Adora, never would ever in her life say Catra's unattractive, not when she's 99, she'll still be the prettiest person she met, the girl is so perfect in the blondes eyes, always will, inside and out.

Her jawline was absolutely perfect, her chin was lying down as she wrote the name, lips perfectly plumped, and she's so focused. The girl was perfect, and how did Adora fall so deep? Catra's long fingers were perfectly cut and kept in line, hitting the wood table, foot tapping on the ground softly waiting for the next name.

Her face glowed in the soft sun, watching closely you could see the freckles peeking out from the concealer she was wearing, blue and yellow eyes, blinking softly on the page, "Adora, was it 3?" Catra asks, and Adora is smiling, turning back and nodding at the girl.

Catra works on the three, watching closely at her writing making sure it's readable, the line calms, and Adora checks her phone, watching the time, and typing something, possibly texting someone.

"Who's tokoyama?" Catra bluntly comments, catching the blonde off guard, and she looks up, and for a second her pupils are shaky, eyes looking down at her hands.

"Heh, just an old supervisor, he works mornings." Adora replies, and Catra seems there is more to the story, maybe something big, she's still writing names, and she badly wants to know, her noisy brain, thinking so loud about it, but it's not her trauma to share, it isn't.

“Something happened?” Catra asks, and Adora’s looking at what seems to be a fallen tree, “You don’t have to say anything now, I’m always here.”

“Hm, ok.” Adora gives a slight nod before standing and walking over as someone waved her over, the girl asks for a few raffles before giving Catra the information, then sitting back, closely watching the customers.

“I think I like you Catra.” Adora says, and it’s so out of the blue, it startles Catra, and she processes it, brain gears moving so quick and fast, and Adora’s looking at her with such, *love.*

She’s being for real.

“Don’t answer.” Adora talks, and it gives Catra time to think, and she agrees that of course she Adores Adora, loving her so much it hurts, but she would never admit how quickly she fell, and is falling.

“I- think i do too.” Catra replies quietly, softly holding the pen, and Adora smirks, and dread deepens into Catra’s soul, and it scares her, so much, way too much.

“You’re funny Catra, really.” Adora comments, and it’s weird, does she think Catra’s lying, shouldn't it be the other way around.

"... What?" Catra drops the pen, actually looking at the girl, Adora looks away with a sad smile forming.

"Don't lie Catra." Adora says, and Catra wants to reach out desperately, fingers twitching, she wants the beautifly blonde to listen to her, actually listen to her, hear her, feel her, she wants her, Catra isn't lying, never would be about love.

"I'm serious, why would I lie?" Catra's trying to stay calm, she thinks she understands Adora's pain maybe a bit, something, anything, a small sliver of it, of course she understands trust issues, she gets it, it's not something words can just fix. Time.

"I trust you Catra, but-" Adora stops talking when Catra grabs her hands, eyes snap up, Catra's brows are furrowed, softly looking at the blonde, the girl's breath is heavy, sigh meeting her lips, "God. This is so dumb."

"It's not." Catra says, and Adora stands, going to sell another raffle, and Catra hates how Adora's shaking, and she hates that the girl looks so distressed since that one boy was here.

The cars calm again, and it seems Adora's a bit calmer, they're both writing names down, Adora's not talking Catra trying to make any conversion, and then Adora speaks up, "I'm sorry."

“Give me a chance, you dumb blonde.” Catra says, and Adora laughs and it’s so beautiful.

“Ok, then do something nice.” The blonde pouts, eyes softening.

“No.”

“You’re so mean.”

“You tell me every ten seconds.”

“Wah.”

**

Adora and Catra both work tonight, Kyles off. They both chill at Adoras, Adora was exhausted not getting any sleep and Having school after work too, she’ll be so tired, she’s running herself so thin. Catra and Adora were sitting on Adora’s couch, Adora was petting her cat, Catra sitting on the other side.

“We're the same age, right?” Catra asks, and Adora looks up from her cat, the cat meows, and Adora stops for a moment because she won't be able to sleep till like tomorrow after school? (if she does)

“Mh?” Adora hums in question, she had no idea what Catra had said, she must’ve zoned out

“How old are you?” Catra repeats, “Don’t think too hard about it, geeze.” Catra says after a moment, she thinks Adora might be dissodationing a bit again, maybe she’s thinking a little too hard, yawning softly.

“17. Why?” Adora replies, leaning her head on the side of the couch, soft lips pouting, petting the meowing cat, who now had hopped into Catras arms, meowing loudly.

“Same.” Catra replies, and Adora’s looking away, not at the girl whatsoever, making Catra uncomfortable, she’s not really sure what to do, Adora’s always been such an awkward person, maybe there is something wrong with her, she’s not really sure.

“Why?” Adora repeated, breath staggering her throat, out of all the times to have a panic attack, now? God she hates herself so much, good thing she’s good at hiding it.

“I was wondering, is that all.” Catra replies, her voice is so calm, and Adora’s taking it in, trying so hard to focus on that and not the heartbeat that is beating so loud in her ears, her hands sweat, making her fingers wet and clammy. She holds them into small fists, and god, it feels like she’s dying.

“Oh.” SHe tries. Lips tight, and she wants the brunette to talk more, so she can focus on that, she’s desperately wishing she’ll talk about anything.

“Mh, not feeling like talking?” The brunette hums, petting the meowing cat, *she’s so talkative,* Catra thinks.

“Sorry.” Adora mutters, her heart calming down, maybe the whole attack is too.

“Living alone seems nice.” Catra’s trying a new approach, seeing the blonde panic isn’t something she enjoy’s, she can tell the blonde is somewhat handling it.

“It is.” Adora replies, sharp, no emotion to it, just talking, she does talk like that alot.

Mara jumps away from Catra, going over to her food bowl, hitting it with her nose stretching herself out, and shaking her fur.

“I’ll be back.” Adora sighs, standing from her spot, and Catra cringes at how much effort it takes her, *she needs sleep* . They both do it honestly.

Adora walks over to Mara, gently patting her soft head, she grabs her food before placing it into the bowl, then grabbing the water as well.

Adora’s feeling more calm now, she’s glad mara was there to help, even though all she did was whine for food, but she’s proud of her furry friend, “You live with your parents?” Adora sighs, walking back over to the couch, Catra was sitting on her phone.

“Yea,” Catra doesn't look, and Adora understands. Catra feels uncomfortable, and Adora gets it, her parents were kinda shity to.

“You don’t have to talk about them. I get it.” Adora says, and all Catra wants is to talk about it, but she doesn’t? But does, she doesn’t understand her stupid brain.

“I want to- I dunno, maybe?” Catra stutters, words harder to find than usual.

“It’s your wish, Catra.” Adora sighs, and she’s not looking at the girl, busy looking out of her window, It comforts Catra that shes not looking.

“... I don't think my parents like me very much..” Catra mutters, she's cracking her knuckles, harshly cracking them, sighing softly.

“Care to elaborate?” Adora’s voice is very strong, and Catra latches on to it, she doesn't get how she trusts the girl so much.

“No.” Catra replies, Adora gets it, If Catra doesn't want to talk about it, Adora won't make her.

“Alright then,” Adora checks the time, they need to leave soon, since they’re both working the AM shift, and honestly Adora’s not looking forward to it.

“Are we leaving soon?” Catra asks, and Adora can tell she also doesn’t want to work either, the both of them, then.

“Yeah, we can leave around 8:30.” Adora replies, and Catra nods, and Adora did live close, and she was a good driver.

The time was hitting 8:20 and they were both pretty much ready to go, they both changed into their uniforms, and they were heading out to the car, both of them grabbing their phones, Adora locks the door and then heads downstairs.

“Who’s tonight's staff?” Catra asks, and Adora thinks for a moment cause she has no clue, she thinks a bit more, she makes a turn, the water from the rain hitting off and onto the sidewalk.

“Mh, probably the regular.” Adora replies to her, turning into the shop, Catra sighs, getting out of the car they both enter the

building, They both look around, Kyle was there, but he was leaving at 12, he was taking earlier shifts, Adora remembers Kyle telling her that.

"Adora." Kyle jurys over, a smile plastered on his face, And Adora smiles back, she doesn't feel like smiling. Tired. Anyways she does, looking around at the others working, she grabs her phone checking the time tables, she figures that since Lonnie's on dT cash and is leaving at 4, she'll keep her there till 3, or 4, still of course giving the girl time to count her cash.

And Imains on front till, 2 and that's fine Adora can place a cash there at 4, it's very much fine, and Adora can take a sandwich and help front, she's sure Catra's good on DT and of course Adora will help, she thinks everything will go fine today.

Everything does go smoothly, Kyle leaves, and then Imain, then of course, Lonnie and Catra leaves at 5. Adora leaves at 6. She headed to school, tiredness was creeping up on him, and everyone was so loud, and annoying, she really can't wait to be done with school.

She works the next night too, like always, and she knows she's working on only three hours of sleep and it's murdering her, but she's handling it, she'll handle it until saturday. She'll be fine, and everything will work out, Saturday rolls around, and all Adora wants is to sleep. Nothing more.

When Adora comes home Saturday morning, she sighs, crashing on her couch, she's so tired. So tired, yawning she falls asleep

right there on the couch. When Adora comes too, she startles awake, mind blank and she’s out of breath, she’s getting tired of the tightness contracting her breathing lately.

Trauma bonding ig

Chapter Summary

comfort.

saturday, - Store 128990

22:49

|| Chapter Seven.}|

[Catra]: It;s so boring here

[Adora]: Yea?

[Catra]: Yes

[Adora]; Busy?

[Catra]: Yeah, but it’ll be slow later, sundays r

[Adora]: oh

[Catra]: Y saturdays

[Adora]; It was because of my parents but i live alone now so idk

[Catra]: makes sense ig

[Adora]: Yea

[Catra]: Where your parents good?

[Adora]; wtf catra

[Catra]: Im being fr

[Adora]: My parents r dead catra

[Catra]: Im so sorry

[Adora]; Its fine,

[Catra]: im here if u wanna talk

[Catra]: How long have u lived alone for? :

[Adora]; not long

[Catra]: Im sorry ab ur parents

[Adora]: they did when I was a kid, i dont remember them.

[Catra]: so you were talking ab ur foster parents? Adopted ones

[Adora]; U r so noiseyy

[Catra]: I wanna learn ab u

[Adora]: COORRRNYYYY

[Catra]: this is why i am mean to u

[Adora]; I like u better when ur mean

[Catra]: good to know

[Adora]: So its not busy?

[Catra]: soso

[Adora]: off and on

[Catra]: yup

[Adora]: will you come over after?

[Catra]: of course

[Adora]; ty

[Catra]: do not thank me u goof

[Adora]: Thats so mean

[Catra]: Ik

[Adora]; I wanna cuddle

[Catra]: you always do

[Adora]: sorry

[Catra]: you havent been doing well, have u?

[Adora]; no

[Catra]: Y

[Adora]: i'll lyk when i figure it out

[Catra]: ok

[Adora]: i'll see u later

[Catra]: yes ofc

Catra comes over around quarter to six, the sun was starting to rise and Adora was sitting on the couch, blanket was around her shoulders, hair messily hitting her shoulders, her hair was so pretty, and looked so soft, and touchable, and she locks the door behind her when she enters, taking off her shoes and walking over to the blonde.

Catra and Adora, had been dating for a few months, they both didn't think it would last that long, nothing doing it for fun, but they found that they actually might *love* each other which was weird because they both were filled with alot of unsolved truma, they needed each other.

Adora turns her head looking at the girl, smiling softly, she tries not to force it, but she really can't really, she's so exhausted, and Catra can tell she hasn't slept in a while, she figures that Adora hasn't been doing well longer then Catra thought.

"Hey, Mara." Catra greets, bending down to pat the cat, Mara trails her feet, meowing, and Catra thinks the cat is so loud, almost like a dog.

The cat meows trotting over to the side of couch, she hops up, rubbing her face against the blonde, who was now looking at Catra's hands, adora tended to do that, looking at peoples hands, Catra's never brought it up with the girl, never having the meaning too.

She maybe gets it, maybe, but she sits, petting the soft fur of the cat, she doesn’t say anything getting into a comfortable position, Adora sighs leaning back, she hesitates, almost not wanting to, it makes Catra frown.

“Cuddles?” Catra asks, making sure the blonde is okay with being touched by the brunette's soft hands, and when she gives a small whine, the girl pushes Adora into her arms and cradles her head making her feel safe.

“Thank you.” Adora sighs, and she feels so much better, she doesn’t understand how she trusts the brunette so much, but she guesses it makes sense, they are perfect for eachother.

“Don’t thank me,” Catra repeats, “You're helping me more than yourself.” Catra, of course would do anything to be around Adora, she’s never had super close friends, scorpia was one and she had Entrapta and Scorpia’s girl friend (The flowery one). She never understood how people trusted so easily, but here she is.

“Are you feeling okay?” Adora asks, and Catra forgot how good Adora is at reading people. She of course gets it, it’s pretty easy to read people when you’re scared of them, Adora was scared of almost everyone, and Catra gets it, adoras a very anxious person.

“My moms a bit mad at me.” She replies, she sounds a bit unsure, but Adora can tell she wants to talk about it, and she can feel the girl relaxing.

“You don’t have to tell me.” Adora replies, and Catra shushes her, and Adora would never force the girl, and anyways Adora would love to learn more about Catra, knowing Catra would want to know about her.

“I would like to.” Carra replies, and Adora snuggles closer comforting her girlfriend, “My parents fight a lot, and it’s just like i'm in between them two, and they want so much from me- I-”

“Take a breath, love.” Adora replies, letting the girl squeeze her hand softly, Adora was watching her very closely, making sure the girl doesn’t push herself.

Catra takes a deep breath, “I feel so overwhelmed, and they’re my parents- I can’t hate them- but they push me so far, I- I should be grateful.”

“It’s okay to have emotions, Catra.” Adora reassures, and she feels bad, and Catra feels bad too, they’re both feeling the same emotions, both feeling it together, “I’m so sorry you have to endorse that, Love, you don’t deserve it.”

And everything came crashing down. Catra feels the tears tipping over, and soft hands wiping them off, and Catra feels so safe, and she loves being around Adora, and Adora is her safe point.

".. Catra." Adora sighs, the tiredness drips off her tone, and Catra knows that Adora's falling asleep, which she never does unless she feels very safe, (Catra had learned that the hard way.)

"I'll stay, don't worry, sleep." Adora relaxes and Catra would want Adora to hurt her back, so she decided that it would be best to move the blonde, only if the girl would let her.

Adora never felt safe when she was tired, dazed, or even drowsy, she hated the feeling of not having control, that someone else could control her, it was torture and she hated it.

"Hey, Adora." Catra tries, her tone being nothing like earlier, and of course she still feels sad, and she wants to curl up and cry, she wants to sleep so bad, but she knows her bad back will hurt, along with the blonde.

"Would you like me to carry you to bed?" Catra gives her a choice, and will always give her choices, since it had been stirpped away from her for so long, she deserves it. They both deserve the world. `

"May I walk?" Adora asks, and she must be super tired, she was before, probably coming down from a high, which Catra could see happens so much, and Catra understands, they both get up, and Catra's not touching the blonde, not gilding, letting the blonde choose, Adora scoops up the small cat bringing her along.

They both end up falling asleep.

When Catra wakes up, Adora isn't there, and she panics for a few moments, and when Adora comes back, smiling and petting mara in her hands, Adora must feel calmer with Mara.

“Morning, lovely.” Adora plops the cat back in her bed, joining as well.

“‘Morning. Have you been up for awhile?” Catra’s resting her head on her shoulder, hands going to pet the cat meowing at streatching near her.

“Not long.” Adora says she sits on the bed, Mara is now rolling over, paws sticking out, and Adora looks more stressed, Catra presumes.

“What's on your mind?” Catra asks, and Adora looks back at Catra, she gives a genuine smile, petting the soft cat, which Catra was already doing, and Adora bothers to lightly touch the tanned girl's skin.

“It’s um.-..” Adora stutters, deep grey eyes zeroing on Catra hands, the brunette makes them more seeable. Her hair is loosely dropping all over her face, big rough knots tangled between the locks, Adora looks down at her phone, and it’s vibrating.

Adora sighs, and she hands Catra the phone, and Catra looks, it’s from a number she doesn't know, she had thought it was the manager, but nonetheless it’s not, she scrolls up a bit reading more messages.

Adora doesn't move when the brunette keeps moving it up, and Catra feels like this is very stressful for the blonde, she ever so gently wraps her arm around the blonde, pulling her into the Catra’s shoulder.

“May I read it?” Catra asks, and of course she asks, never would ever make a choice for the blonde, she always would let the blonde choose for herself.

“I gave it to you, Didn't I?” Adora chuckles, sharp eyes darted down to the phone, watching closely.

Catra agrees, reading through the messages, it’s not pleasant and is very one sided, Catra does not enjoy reading the messages, she looks at Adora, her pupils are shaking, and if looks like shes panicking.

08|23|2020

[Unknown]: When are you planning on making more hours?

[Adora]: I’m already making 90 a week. I have school

[Unknown]: Do not talk back to me, we need you.

[Adora]: Im sorry, ill work it out.

[Unknown]: you better.

08|26|2020

[Unknown]: You planning on telling anyone?

[Adora]: ofc not

[Unknown]: You know better, things could get ugly, you know this

[Adora]: Ik

[Unknown]: cya tonight

[Adora]: ok.

Catra feels a soft shiver, and a heavyweight hits her shoulder, and the room is dead silent, scaring the brunette. Catra looks at the blonde, she looks so scared, and usually when the girl gets scared she shuts down, dissociating.

But she’s not, she's completely present, eyes are scanning the phone, shaken, so very scared.

She skips past a few messages, going down back to more recents; who is this person anyways?

Catra decides that she doesn’t enjoy reading this, and Adora didn’t seem comfortable, and Catra didn’t want the blonde to feel unsafe, and this wasn’t it. Adora moved a bit, dropping her forehead on Catra’s shoulder, she sighs.

“It’s not bad, right?”

Her voice hits Catra ears, the tips of her fingers tingling, and she feels bad, because Adora is nice, too nice, and so calm, and so suptive when Catra’s upset, or when she had her off days, and Adora has had her fair shares of off, god everyone does, but Adora’s just so closed off.

"..Adora, who was that?" Catra coats, she gently grabs one of Adora hands, rubbing her knuckles softly, and Adora hasn't lifted her head, and it doesn't seem like she wants too, and that's alright, it's okay if the girl won't talk about it, it's all trauma, and that takes so long to uncover.

"It's.. just um- Tokoyama," The blonde replies sharp, and it's very tight, and Mara has now walked over, meowing loudly and scaring Adora, and Catra gently pats the cat telling her to calm down.

"Oh." Catra sighs a breath, calmy stroking Adora's knuckles, she brings them up to her lips kissing them softly, and Catra knows that calms the girl.

"I'm being dramatic. Sorry."

"Do not say that. You are allowed to be upset." Catra's tone is so much stronger, and Adora's eyes trail to Catra's face, the girl looks so calm. "I will never judge you for being upset."

"I just don't get why he's still texting me." Adora replies, and her voice is so quiet, but she was so close to Catra's ear it sounded more loud. Catra wishes she could take Adora's pain from her, the girl speaks up again, soft lips brushing against Catras shoulder, where the girl's head was resting still.

"I want to block him, but I can't, I- it would start so much drama- I don't" Adora stutters, her hands are shaking in Catra's and she

really hates it, she never noticed that Adora and Tokoyama had so much backstory, honestly they don't work together both being very spread out, he comes in at 7, leaving at 3, and Adora comes in a 9, and working till 6.

"You guys don't work together." Catra says, calmly. "I don't think he would go after you, he doesn't know where you live. Right?"

"Mh, I don't think so." She replies, and Catra grabs back the phone, reading the messages from today, and of course Catra has no context, but she knows that they used to work together, and Adora doesn't feel comfortable around him at all.

05/21/2022

13;13

[Tokoyama] : going to tell your short friend?

[Adora]: ofc not

[Yokyuma]: Tell her, i go to the manager.

[Adora]: okay.

Catra’s anger fumes from her ears, making her squeeze Adora hands harder, she stops when Adora gives a sleight shuffle, telling the brunette it’s *too much.* " Don’t worry, I’ll never force you to tell me, I promise.”

“You promise.” Adora’s voice is so quiet, so soft.

“I promise.”

“I love you.” She mutters.

Catra brushes the blonde hair back, and Adora bites her lip, curling more into herself, her shaking creased. And that's a plus, she’s okay with the blonde calming down.

Adora leaves for work around 9:30, Catra stays at Adoras, she barely goes back to her house, she wouldn’t admit it but she’s scared to go back to her parents, but if Adora asked her to leave, she would do it, again, she trusts Adora, and since they've been together Catra has felt so much safer.

[Adora]: This bitch has me train during rush ?!?

[Catra]: PLS

[Adora]: nah im being fr, it’s not now but omfg

[Catra]: at least ur shift is almost done

[Adora]: i wanna die

[Catra]: was it fun?

[Adora]: no

[Catra]: r u staying early

[Adora]: yea manager wants updates on new girl

[Catra]: ofc he fucking does

[Adora]: sorry

[Catra]: imma sleep for a bit, love you gn

[Adora]: ofc sleep well.

Adora hates this person, Kyle can tell, the looks Adora's giving him is funny, yes, but Adora just looks like a stressed babysitter.

"Calm down, it's fine- Kyle, can you grab a green cloth?" Adora mutters, she's turned away from the fool working on drinks, she's trying to be patient , but my god the manager had told Adora that the girl had worked here.

Adora hears her phone ring, she checks the number before asking Kyle (who had just come back with a paper towel for the mess). And it wasn't busy so she doesn't mind leaving Kyle to babysit.

"Adora speaking." Adora replies, and she's checking the biscuits while waiting for the person to reply, they do, and it's just the manager, which causes anger here but there is nothing she can do but be nice to the man.

She comes back after her call, telling Kyle what he said, they both help the new girl, watching closely and teaching her, she was supposed to be taught but there again, there is nothing Adora can do.

She was on her phone for a while, there were no customers and the store was clean, stalked and they were just waiting for the 5AM staff after the girl left.

She's texting some of her friends from school, which to be fair she really doesn't talk to them that is.

Glimmer; who is ranting about the sexist teacher is giving her a headache and is only texting.

Bow; Who is just reasoning with fait, and it’s almost cruel that Kyle doesn't have friends.

And overall Adora loves her friends, she loathes their life, it seems so simple and easy, and of course she knows that Glimmer's life isn’t sparkles and rainbows, but she wants to go trade places so badly. She can’t.

They angrily text for a bit more, Adora gets bored closing the chat and going over to Kyle, it’s not busy so she knows he doesn't mind.

“How’s it-” She stops talking when she sees Kyle’s stressed face and the huge mess of coffee all over the place.

“Overfill.” Kyle comments dryly, walking over and grabbing the picture and putting coffee into it, Adora grabs paper towels helping the new person clean the mess.

“It gets the better of us.” Adora mutters, now the mess was clean, she was sending the new person to clean the pots, it wasn't busy so they could manage with only one pot, and starting sugar.

“Kyle?” Adora asks. and she’s aware of Kyle’s self doubt, she’s never had the glory of dealing with it, but she’s of course fine with it.

“Yeah?” Kyle replies, he’s not looking, and Adora doesn’t push that she understands, she gets it

“You okay?” She asks, and it’s hard, cause she never will ever get how to help someone, or comfort, she’s the worst at it, but she knows that Kyle, isn’t use to comfort, he often was bullied, his truma is so deep-rooted, but isn’t everyones?

“Yeah, I- i’m thinking.” He looks at her, and Adora knows he’s thinking way too hard, and she does it too, way too deep in the head, it hurts her, but everyone has problems, and ways to cope, it’s not an easy life. It never was planned to be.

“Mh, thinking, eh?” Adora comments, and no, she has no clue what the blonde is thinking about, and she has no right to ask if Kyle wanted to tell her, Adora would listen in a heartbeat, but he doesn’t want to share, it’s clear.

“I don’t like women.” Kyle replies fearful, scared and quiet, it’s heartbreaking. She hates when Kyles is scared, (which is way too often per her liking.) She does not enjoy this at all.

“Ok.”

“But- I believe I should, like- everyone likes the opposite, I’m supposed to like them- I- can’t- um.” He’s a stuttering mess, not being able to ground himself at all.

“That’s not true, You can love whoever you feel best with,” She’s calm when she talks, staying calm was something Adora was so good at. Something trained.

“You don’t get it.” He shivers, shifting the sugar back and forth watching the sugar fall into the pot, it was a slow process and they both did not like it.

“I do not get it, but I understand. I’ll never understand how you feel, but I do get the jus.” She replies, and Kyle looks up, Adora isn’t looking at him, she’s stirring something Kyle couldn’t place. He doesn’t ask.

“You’re a perfect blonde. Don’t act dumb.”

“You’re not blonde?” The blonde girl replies, jokenly, but still completely serious.

“This is not the point. Adora.” Kyle’s getting frustrated, he again looks back from the sugar, placing the container down in the cabinet.

“I know. Sorry.”

Adora walks over to the office, away from the place where they were, going over to the office, and updating the notes, she also reads the notes from the mornings, and checks the sales rate.

“Um. Kyle.” New person comes out, and they both had kinda forgot, there are no customers, and she was just cleaning, which can not be hard, but you know, people are dumb.

Adora naros out what they were saying not feeling like actually listening, she was now reading the notes from the manager, she knew she was here till at least 6, which is pretty normal, she just hopes it’s not after 7, because she is exhausted.

Adora grabs a marker and starts the positions for the next day, she thinks the new girl is leaving, and she’s fine with that, she doesn’t care, she really doesn’t mind, she checks her phone, it’s now 4;31 she only has a few minutes before rush, and of course she’s isn’t prepared. Never would be.

“Hey.” Sara walks in, and Adora does enjoy Sara, she always comes in early for her shift, Adora thinks she needs more hours maybe, she’s not sure.

“Hi. I just finished the position chart.” Adora replies, she doesn’t have her hat on anymore, it’s sitting down by the desk, and her hair is messy but it’s been 8 hours, and she’s okay with that, her

eyes are fixtaded on placing training notes on the new girl, and whatnot.

“Is the safe out?” Kyle asks, and she had no clue he was even in the office, but of course he is, he seems to always be near her, even if he’s upset with her. They’re close.

“It’s there I counted it, you just have to bring it out.”

“Mh Ok. Thank you.” Kyle replies, and Adora nods, her fingers are fastly tapping keys, writing this note as quick as possible so she could give updates, once she does she looks at her phone.

[Catra]: #Depressedcausemygfwontanswer.

[Adora]: bffr

[Catra]: come home pls

[Adora]: Can you make food ?

[Catra]: sure, what did u want

[Adora]: idk im starving soo

[Catra]: Have u eaten since u left

[Adora]: Ofc not

[Catra]: Ok, i'll make something

[Adora]: tysm ilysm

[Catra]: ilytoo.

Catra hadn’t noticed before, and she knows that it was not obvious, it wouldn’t be if you didn’t live with her. Adora rarely eats, and if she does, it’s a blessing, Adora’s almost always busy, and it hurts Catra, cause the girl doesn’t put her needs first, and probably never will.

Catra sighs, she will never make a big deal over Adora eating, she would never do that to her poor girlfriend. “This isn’t for you Mars.” Catra grabs the cat taking her off the counter, and onto the floor, the cat sits at her feet, meowling.

Adora comes home around quarter to 8, which is 10 hours, which Catra seems fine, for someone only working once, twice, part time, not full time 6 days a week of 10 hour shifts.

“Mara!” Adora sighs, the cat misses her lots, Adora sighs, holding the cat, Adora never sees her cat, being sad about her being gone all day the cat meows some more.

“I fed her.” Catra comments, and that had been a routine, it's not a sharp one, but Catra doesn’t work as often and is home to feed Mara, so she stepped forward and did it.

(Adora has an automatic feeder, and would feed Mara on her breaks.)

“Thank you, Lots.” Adora replies, flat, she’s honestly so tired.

“Of course.”

“What are you making?”

“Noodles.” Catra sighs, she’s stirring a pot, and it seems that yeah she is making something that includes water, and a pot.

“Hhpm.”

“I’ll be on the couch. Do not burn the place down.” Said Adora, while walking to the couch.

“I will not burn noodles, tuts.”

Adora does not reply. She walks over to the couch, slouching down with the cat in her arms.

Catra finishes up doing the food, she doesn't really do much for it, deciding that whatever was fine to not make so much, Adora doesn’t even eat that much anyways.

Catra comes back with the food, pushing the cat away, and sitting down next to the blonde, they both eat quietly, they didn’t have much to say, and since Adora had just come back from work she was exhausted. There was also no school.

“What time will you go to bed?” Catra asks, and she’ll clean the mess that is the kitchen before Adora freaks out, Catra knows she will.

“Later, I have some school work to catch up on some school work.” Adora deflates, she’s upset about it but Catra does not push, would never push.

Adora does end up doing school work, being more tired than normal, but she doesn’t think much of it, she's working on journaling for one of her classes. She'll be so happy when she’s done with highschool.

She changes into some sweats and a cotton tee, she hops into bed, Catra has been in the kitchen cleaning her food mess, making sure to keep it clean since it is her place.

truth

Chapter Summary

more comfort

saturday, - Store 128990

22:49

|| Chapter eight. ||

Adora doesn’t like her parents at all, she would never enjoy talking about her childhood. Never would want to talk about it, not like she remembers.

Adora remembers absolutely nothing from her parents, not that she knew them. Adora had grown up in foster care, hoping back and forth from home to home, it was very scary as a little child. She does remember walking into houses, most of the parents wanted money, or someone for looks.

She remembers the rules, the punishments, and how she always had been good, great even, and she did. She really tried. It wasn’t fair.

Sometimes she gets really scared, breath staggering in fear, hands shaking. She hates the feeling so much and nothing at the same time, and she understands she does. She doesn’t enjoy it.

“Hey.” Catra sighs, she’s not standing too close, Adora’s too deep in her head it would cause more harm, and would make the blonde panic more. She gently picks up the broken glass making sure the girl couldn’t harm herself.

“I’m not mad at you. It’s alright, it’s just a cup.” She whispers, and she’s seen the blonde dissociate, but never this deep in a panic attack. Adora’s way to good at masking things.

Adora's mind is back at that place, back when she had to stay in line, had to be the best: Was the best. Her mind was racing heart beating so fast and she swore she was dying. She’s going to die, She’s going to beat her till she dies.

Catra waits till Adora has completely calmed down, not knowing how to help at all, she really hates seeing Adora in so much pain. Too much pain to feel this at such a young age.

When Adora comes back , looking at Catra with way too much fear in her dull blue eyes, Catra feels so much rage.

“Hey..” Catra tries again, and Adora shakes her head, keeps hiding her face, whimpering, Catra understands, she stands softly turning off the bigger light leaving the small stove one on, she hopes that helps.

“Mara.” Catra whispers to the cat, trying to be quiet to not disturb the blonde, her girlfriend needed some splace, and Mara wasn’t helping when the girl calms down, the cat would help definitely.

A while later Adora looks back up, it’s later in the night now, Catra had called them both in, and Kyle said he would fill for Adora, and Catra wasn’t working, Adora would freak out later, but Catra would be able to calm her down, and Kyle doesn;t work as much anymore so he was okay for a few hours.

“Adora,” Catra whispers softly, and she’s holding a small pill of water next to her. Mara had fallen asleep in Adora’s bed, probably being tired of something. “I brought you this, it’ll make your head feel better.”

Adora whimpers again, everything was too much, she makes effort to put her hand out, woundering what Catra wants, she trusted the multcoloured eyed girl so much, her hands shake and she’s woundering why she still feels so bad.

“Do not choke.” Catra softly says handing her the water, and Catra knows Adora’s childhood wa scary for her, the girl couldn’t even talk about it withought shaking or zoning out, so Catra never brought it up.

Adora takes the pill and she’s calming down she thinks, and she exhaautsed now, eyes dirftubg off, Catra repeats, “May I touch you Adora? I won't if you don’t want me to, it’s completely fine.”

“I want to sleep.” The blonde says so quiet, and small, and Catra undertsands. And she will let Adora, sleep, why wouldn’t she.

“Ok. Alright, I can bring you to your room then?”

“...Please.” Adora still sounds scared, but at least she's aware. And somewhat present.

They both go into the room, Adora slags through the doorway falling onto the bed, face down into the cat. Catra smiles, she can see how Adora’s shoulders untense.

“Would you like me to leave?” Catra asks, she doesn’t know if Adora will answer she doesn’t care if she doesn’t or does.

“C-an you stay?” The brunette understands, walking over and slightly sitting on the bed, she waits to see if the girl would come closer for comfort, and when Adora slides her way over, Catra ever so softly places her hand on the blonde's head, and the girl keens it.

Adora falls asleep later on, being super tired, Catra isn't the most tired so she once Adora falls asleep goes back into the kitchen still cleaning up the mess of the cup Adora dropped, the reason for the whole messy attack.

Adora wakes up a lot later. Mara is completely gone probably to find food, knowing that Catra is there it makes her heart swell. It's so warm and fuzzy, it’s a good thing. Adora slowly takes her blanket pushing it over to the other side of the bed, she shivers as she hops off.

She was expecting to have some type of headache, a dull pain was hitting the top of her head, but that was about it, she was pleasantly surprised.

“Ay sleepdead you’re awake.” Catra says, her voice is still light, gently Adora nods guilding herself to the bed, sitting down and looking at the brunette, Catra looked so pretty and well sitting on the couch, soft hands rubbing the head of Mara.

“Thank you.” Adora rasps, Catra’s hand hovers over Adora’s knee, not touching ng just yet, hovering. When Adora doesn’t flinch Catra places it down, gently rubbing it with her thumb, It calms the blonde down again.

“Anytime.” Catra’s smiling softly, eyes full of spirit love, and joy and Adora would love for her eyes to look so happy and carefree, not being scared of everything, and everyone.

“Kyle took your shift, you’ll have to thank him.”

“I will.” Adora replies, she snuggles mutley closer to the blonde, even closer than usual, easily slipping into her arms, Catra holds

her pretty closes, rubbing back her soft hair out of the blondes eyes, she notes that it’s pretty greasy and messy, she thinks Adora might need to wash it soon.

“Mh, When’s the last time you washed your hair?” Catra tsks, she also thinks a shower would do Adora some good, showers seem to tend to people and their cleanliness.

“I don’t remember, Sorry.” She replies, lightly still oh very soft, and it really makes Catra wanna cry but she doesn’t just rest her head on the blonde's neck, smelling the scent of her.

To Catra Adora always seemed to smell like coffee, Adora does work at a coffee shop 6 days a week for 10 hours. But she doesn’t think Adora smells like the coffee they sell there. More like a fresh coffee bean, so crisp and strong, but enough sweetness to make it smell more fresher and Catra loves the scent, she wonders what she smells like to the other?

“That’s fine.” Catra brings her hand to rest on Adora’s lower back, gently rubbing up and down, and scratching it with her nails, holding the tallers hand, comforting herself more than Adora, “Would you like to shower?” Catra asks, and it’s weird because this is Adora’s house, but Adora was raised not having freedom to do things by herself, and Catra gets that and understands.

“Later.” Adora sighs, she thinks she’s falling back asleep, but she’s okay with that, she wonders if Catra would get mad about it, she doesn’t think so, but she never really knows with the Catra, she’s

still scared, not at Catra, she would never get scared of the short brunette, she could easily take her out.

"Alright," Catra sighs looking at the tine, the clock is hitting 6AM, and Catra has to attend school soon, which makes the blonde very sad that Catra's dumb enough to get summer school, but she wont push.

'Are you leaving soon?" Adora looks up at her, gentle eyes scanning the face, and Catra nods, shifting the position.

"Like 5 minutes." She replies, going to stand, and Adora whines but she understands.

"Ok." She says in return.

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TW:

MENTIONS OF SH/SCARS

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Adora gets her lazy ass off the couch, finally going opening her phone, she doesn't see any of the text messages at first, she had DND on but once she takes that off she sees alot a messages, it's funny how this was over a tiny cup that she spilled, she really is such a baby.

[Kyle]: I did ur shift do not worry ab repaying me, i owed u anyways, were even.

[Adora]: Sorry. And ty.

[Kyle]: Ofc, did u relapse

[Adora]: I didn't

[Kyle]: I'm proud.

[Adora]: Dont.

[Kyle]: I'm being srs.

[Adora]: Thats the problem, you'll be disappointed when i do relapse.

[Kyle]: I’d be proud nonetheless, dw.

[Adora]: Good to know

[Kyle]: we grew up together

[Adora]: Ik

[Kyle]: Have you told Catra ab it?

[Adora]: no.

[Kyle]: she livws w you .

[Adora]: Im having a hard time

[Kyle]: Ive seen

[Adora]: thanks for that

[Kyle]: no more cup dropping ok?

[Adora]: Mh ok

[Kyle]: I think you should tell Catra

[Adora]: Idk. I dont trust her yet .

[Kyle]: she lives w u

[Adora]: she will be mad

[kyle] no she will not

[Adora]: im scared

[Kyle]; ik you are

[Adora]: Can we talk ab something else. im ab to shower and idk if ill be clean after that

[Kyle]: I cant force you to not do it. But im proud anyways.

Adora doesn’t know what to say back, just liking the message then going to show, she would never *want* to relapse. It's never really a choice, Adora never really remembers when it happens, she sees the scars and what happens, she knows. Adora has been hiding her scars from Catra, it’s deeply hard, and sometimes she wishes she’d have the guts to do it.

She doesn’t.

Adora slips off her pants, gently placing them to the side, along with the rest of get clothes, she rubs her healed scars on her thighs gently greasing the fresher ones, she doesn’t enjoy her showers, never does, and she wonders why Catra or even other people love showers so deeply, she thinks they’re a waste of time.

However, Catra loves showers, almost always asking the blonde to join her, to be with her and it hurts the blonde deeply when she says no. Being scared of the red lines crossing her soft thighs, it hurts her so much, but she is not ready.

She almost finishes her shower, she grabs the small blade placed under the box of tampons, she wonders if that's a good spot, it doesn’t matter, she grabs it, and it’s pretty slippery in her hands, wet and cold.

She doesn't do much, there isn’t much room on her thighs, being a bit full already and any other place could be seen, and she’s not in the mood to deal with anyone finding out at the moment.

She wipes the soft red blood dripping down into the drain, it makes her feel so good, the stinging sensation hitting the deep of her thigh making her feel so amazing.

She gets out much later, and she does feel better, and of course it’s not from being clean or anything like that, just her thigh pounding and she’s praying Catra doesn't squeeze it, she knows Catra loves that.

She changes into something more comfortable, and texts Kyle something back since she felt bad that she left him on red, then she goes back to the couch, laying back on the couch head looking up at the ceiling. Mara jumps up on her stomach, gently holding her and rubbing the cats back.

Catra comes back at 12, and Adora is still laying on the couch, nothing interesting has happened, maybe the pain has settled on her thighs.

“Hey.” Catra says, throwing her bag on the floor, walking over and patting the cat.

“Are you working tonight?” Adora asks, she seems more present and aware petting the sleeping cat.

“Nah. I think Kyle or Lonnie are?” Catra says in return, she looks down at the blonde, soft and kind look.

“Ok.” *Thank you .*

Adora goes into work, she thinks she’s working with Kyle, maybe even Lonnie, but that’s fine with her. She just doesn’t want to work with Imain, or anyone she’s not close with, but she thinks the shift will go fine.

“Oh, Before you leave. Did you block Tokuyama?” Adora turns, looking at the speaker, which was the burnette, softly sitting on the couch.

“I did.” Adora replies, she smiles softly at Catra, nodding happly, she doesn’t feel happy, maybe never will, but she does feel okay with Catra around, and again, she will never understand why she feels so safe with the blonde, maybe someday she’ll get it, she wonders why the brunette thinks sometimes.

She walks into the shop, clocking in and walking into the office, she knows Kyle usually shows up before her, or at the same time, and he wasn’t here, maybe he wasn’t coming in, which confused her but she’s fine with that.What does make her jaw drop was

who she saw in the office, none other than Tokoyama, she was just talking about him.

"Hey, blondie." Tokoyama says and Adora's breath gasps, holding tightly her hands into fists, nails hitting hard against the soft skin, and it scars her how she's now sweating but she agrees that he should not be here, since he always works at 7AM never has done PM/AM shifts, she really hates this.

"Hi, Tokoyama, sighs, head leaning upwards, higher and taller than the tall blonde, she doesn't look too hard at him, feeling way too bothered to make eye contact.

"Well. I'll be off," Gorge says, and she;d been so focused on the man in front of her she didn't even see her manager at his desk, and of course it was still early and she knew he would be here, but not Tokoyama.

Adora watches her only hope jump out and leave, and it does make her sad, sad enough to want to walk out, but she's a big girl and is fine with it, she can handle it.

She cannot handle this .

Tokoyama is one of the worst workers she has ever seen, and she trains a lot, more than she should need to but he is the worse, she really doesn't like him, most definitely hates him, she wants a

gun she wants to shoot herself so bad, she shouldn't have to deal with this. At all.

The clock strikes midnight and most of the staff that have been there since four leaves, they both clock out and go, grab the tips and walk over clock out and leave, there are only three people on the floor now, and one doing breaks. (And that person is off at 3)

Tokoyama smiles at the customer, thanking them for the pretty big tip, and it makes her so utterly angry, because she hates how he's getting more tips than her, more wadges, she's positive that he makes more a hour than her, he's a favourite, his hair isn't out right now, but it's brownish black, slicky and soft, there is not a pretty reason why she knows that it's so very soft.

She doesn't want to remember pulling it so hard to get him away from her.

She knows what his hands feel like she knows his hands are rough and tight and scary, but there is no reason why she'd know that so keenly, no reason why she wakes up in cold sweats trying to catch her breath desperly, it's so hard, but she doesn't want to remember that part.

She doesn't want to remember any of it.

She makes it through her shift, working with the idiot man that she hates so much, she doesn't enjoy him. She'll never enjoy him,

she hates him. She will never forgive him.

She'll forgive him; she'll have no choice. That's how it works.

Adora is counting the safe when he comes back into the office, holding roughly to the cash, deeping his nails into the fabric of the bag holder, she doesn't think too hard about it, just going back to the safe. And when he walks closer she quivers, and she hates that him out of all people have control over him like that.

"Blondie, you looked mad today, something upsetting you?" He phases, and she doesn't like it, she feels she's been a bit picky about herself and she should loosen, but she feels so tired, and she just wants to die.

"Nothing you can fix." She replies, monotone, not saying anything back, counting the change in her hands, and she vibrates when he comes mutley closer, so quiet and she doesn't like it.

"Are you sure, little one?" He says so creepy, and she almost gags, holding it back, she knows there is a camera there, he cannot do anything.

But he will anyway, right??

She watches him closely as he grabs her shaking hands, dragging her back to the staff bathroom, she wonders why she does not

move, so still, and she knows it’s just them two.

No one else will save you.

He closes the door back with his foot holding her firmly against the doot, pushing her fly hairs back behind her ears, he doesn’t say anything, she knows what will happen, and she’s never prayed so hard for a rush to start, anything to save her. His voice is chilling when he finally speaks, “Don’t hyperventilate, I will not help you. Dear.”

She stutters out nothing, She can't think anymore mind going completely blank, nothness seeping into the deeps of her bones, her fingers tingle, and she feels so sick, and she can’t believe she’s not doing anything, Why can’t she move?

Adora knows that he’s aware that she will dissociate, is dissating, but for some reason he knows not to let her go out of focus, he knows to leave her half presate, keeping her completely frozen in fear, he’s older and stronger, he knows what to do.

“Are you going to listen this time, or will I have to cut them off?” And he’s so smart, she’s gone, listening as if a child would and *he knows,* he knows what he is doing, how is doing it how he will do it, Adora nods, shaking hands going down to her pants, under the belt.

“You've come so– mh, what's that word, attentive–, what happened?” He whispers into the blondes ear, he’s standing in front of her, dick stringing out and touching her lower stomach, Adora’s eyes distanly focus on the back of the wall, feeling nothing in her body, only listening to the deep rumble of the man touching her cheekbone, whispering into her ear and helping her shaky hands upto her pants.

He roughly throws her pants over by the toilet, grabbing her by her shoulder and turning her arounds, Adora’s eyes focus off of the wall, being smushed into the hard cold wall.

He squeezes her ass, saying soft words into her ear, softly whispering again, “I was excited to see you, again. I really missed you.” He’s sniffing her, and it makes the girl sick, but there is nothing she can do, she can’t even move, she’s going to crash so low, so deep later, it’ll suck, and she had a horrible night.

Adora doesn’t remember much from him, and she does not want to. She comes back to herself. She's sitting on the floor, head in her knees, her pants are still off and her hands are shaking so bad, she feels horrible. She wants to die.

Checking the time, she puts her pants up, the stinging sensation hitting her brain making her more aware. It’s only hitting 6 now, she goes back to the safe, finishing it and going home. She still feels horrible.

When Adora comes home, she really doesn’t wanna be touched, almost crying when Mara’s tail hits her leg as it circles her. She

doesn’t say anything, doesn’t make noise, she takes off her shoes, gently placing them beside the door, then making her way to the couch.

She checks her messages when she sees that the brunette is not there, she doesn’t think much of it too deep in her mind to think about anything, she’s almost happy she isn't here, she loves Catra, but not after what just happened.

06:57

[Catra]: going out with scorpia:(

[Adora]:Ok have fun.

Adora takes her time in the shower, she’s bleeding from her backend hurting so bad when she scrubs it clean, trying to get herself clean, she needs to be cleaner. Better.

She falls asleep, exhausted, she doesn’t remember anything before, whole body moving on autopilot.

Catra makes her way home late, not too late, but Adora was dead asleep, knowing that she works and needs to be up for 8, she’s quiet making no noise, she’s already very good at that akreasy.

She cleans up the place. Grabbing the blonde's uniform and making sure it’s ready for the next might, she makes sure the cat is fed, and her water bowl is full, she knows Adora had fed her and filled her bowl since her dirty food bowl was in the skin, and the water was still cold.

Adora arises at three, she comes out her face is tear traced, so pained and scared and it breaks Catras heart, *What got her so on edge?* She watches the blonde closely. The blonde sits on the floor near Catra, Mara was somewheres sleeping nowhere to be found. Catra reaches her hand down, reaching for Adoras hand latches to tight on hers.

“..Adora?” Catra asks quietly, she will not complain about how her hand is being squeezed so hard, but thats with her, Adora seems less stressed.what ever makes Adora feel better would make Catra feel sane.

“...I think- I would like to talk about it.” She’s looking down at the interlocked hands, carefully rubbing the soft skin as the other talks, deeply listening and comforting the blonde.

“It’s your choice.” Catra carefully replies, watching closely.

Adora’s deeply looking down, she hasn’t moved in awhile, Catra can tell she's deep in her head, only thinking about what happened. Catra gently places her hand into Adora’s loose ponytail pulling out the hair tie bringing it to her wrist then her hands going into Adora’s hair, so soft and gentle.

“.I, um," She snuffles her hands and quakes in Catras, Adora coughs a bit, works not coming out. “Do you remember-Tokuyama?’ She asls, voice is tightly strained.

“I’m sorry.” Adora whimpers, and it breaks Catra’s heart, “He.. raped me. I think.”

Catra’s breath stops, heart beating so fast, “That’s not your fault.” Catra replies, and when Adora does not reply, barely breathing. She moves quietly into the ground, softly sitting on her knees, her hand leaves Adora’s hair, the other still holding the soft hand.

Catra let's go if the blondes hands, Adora leans her head in head shoulder, and Catras embracing the hug, rubbing her back, “But I could’ve took got him off of me I could’ve-” She stunters, head pushing so hard on the brunettes shoulder.

“Nope, non of that.” Catra replies her hand rubs the head, gently putting pressure. When Adora winces Catra’s eyes darken, steeming. “Are you hurt?” She asks quietly.

The girl flinches heart leaping into her throat, beating and beating so fast and harshly, she can’t stop, her hand squeezing deeply into Catra’s thin shirt. She’s scared, so very scared. She won't talk, always makes problems.

“You don’t have to talk.” Catra decides, and speaks calm to the blonde, “Would you like anything?” Adora nods, and Catra gets them both up, Adora hides her wince as they get up, she sits on the stool, head placed her head on her arms watching the tanned skinned girl.

“You’re not going back to that place. No questions asked.” Her tone is serious, it starles the blonde but she doesn’t have energy to react.

“Ok.” Adora croatas.

“Alright.” The glass hits the table, small pill beside the cup. Adora watches closely with her eyes unblinking, she does not want to show up to work. She promises she won't show back up again.

“I relapsed.” She blurts. Catra’s falls, and it scares Adora, she puts her head down, eyes hiding. “I’m sorry. A Lot has happened.”

“That's okay. What can I do?” Catra replies.

“I’m not sure..” Adora trails off, head coming back up for air, she doesn’t know what to say. She doesn't know what to do. She’s lost, and confused.

“It’s okay. Thank you for trusting me.”

Adora hands Catra her phone, they're sitting in the bed both in pyjamas, Adora brings her knees up chin resting and watching.

"Would you like me to tell them?" Catra asks, and the fear in Adora's snapping shut eyes tells Catra everything she needs to know. Catra lets Adora know that she's calling, she walks out dialling the number and stepping out,

When she comes back she sighs, "It's all good, they said it's okay. And it's not a quit or fire. A break."

"Thank you." She whispers, head nodding.

"Anything I can do?" Catra asks, and Adora shakes her head, hands petting the cat's soft fur, and Catra hops into bed as well, Adora moves closer, laying down onto her side.

Once they are both laying, Catra grabs Adoras hands softly kissing them, something that they did every night, fair share they both trade it making the other feel loved.

"You're not mad?" Adora speaks so quietly, *too quietly* .

"Of course not."

one day

Chapter Summary

its the end

saturday, - Store 128990

|| Chapter eight. ||

After the whole night, Kyle visits, he already knows what happened the first time with Tokoyama. So he’s there right away when Catra calls him asking him how to comfort Adora, and Adora had also texted him, he desperately wanted to contact Lonnie but he will always let Adora choose who she wants on her side.

“Hey,” he enters, and he is shocked when he sees Lonnie sitting on the side of the bed, it seems it makes sense they’re close. He wouldn’t have guessed that Adora or Catra didn’t tell Lonnie, Lonnie always seems to be around.

“Kyle, I wasn’t aware you knew.” Lonnie sighs, she’s petting the blonde hair, the girl looks to be fast asleep, and he hasn't seen Catra. He walks closer to the too, sitting softly on the floor looking at Lonnie.

“Wried.” Kyle mutters, he doesn’t want to think about why Adora’s lip is busted and her face looks bruised and painful, Adora’s wearing a soft sweater, and is covered by the blanket, she looks sickly pale. It's breaking his heart.

“She hasn’t been eating.” Lonnie sighs, and Kyle agrees, he’s worried and so very aware about the eating.

“Relapsing too.” Kyle answers, nodding, he’s so close to the blonde. Lonnie looks at him as if she didn’t know and he feels so horrible that he lets that slip, his face drops, paling.

“Kyle?” Lonnie asks, her hands pause from the hair, shaking.

“I didn’t mean to-” He shakes his head.

“It’s fine. I’m sure I'll be okay with it.” Lonnie replies, she thinks Adora is too deep in her head to even think about this right now, she will tell Adora, always would, but it’s so much stress.

The stress lessens after time, Catra helps. All her friends do. So she gets somewhat mentally stable. She tries really hard, and it seems impossible, Catra still has a job, not where they used to work. She would never be caught dead there, or around those toxic people.

Catra hasn’t told Adora. She knows she should tell her girlfriend. She should, but Adora is so stressed and Catra will not stress her more with Catra’s problems.

“Got it.” She replies into the phone, she does hate talking to her mother; since she wanted to get back in touch, Catra wishes she could say no.

She walks back into the house, phone being closed into her pocket, she sighs softly petting the blonde's hair as she grabs the chin of the pale girl to kiss her forehead. And the blonde takes it calmly, not flinching which is a step forward.

“Have you eaten today?” Catra asks, sitting next to the blonde, Adoras hand creeps up and into hers, they sit for a few moments.

“I did earlier.” The blonde replies, and Catra believes her, she pets the cat that was sitting in Adora lap, they were both now watching the show that Adora had on, Catra isn’t sure what it’s about but ahes okay with watching it, “Have you?” The blonde asks.

“Yes.” Catra replies, she watches the show, she somewhat understands the show, she’s getting it.

“Ok good.” Adora sighs, leaning onto the brunette's shoulder.

Catra hums, heart beating when she feels her phone vibrate in her pocket, god she really should answer that, but also doesn’t want to leave the warmth of the other.

They sit like that for a while, sitting calmly together always makes each other feel better. Adora can see how stressed her girlfriend is, she doesn’t want to say anything- doesn’t know what to say. She doesn't know how to help.

“Love, how are you doing?” Adora tires, voice stringing along against the tv, Adora wants to say she knows what is bothering Catra, she of course doesn’t know for sure, but she feels that Catra hasn’t told her stuff, since the whole Tokoyama thing. She’s trying.

“I’m ok..” Catra replies, voice tight, the girl doesn’t think she can do this anymore.

“You know you can trust me with things. You don’t have to, i’m here.” Adora lifts up her head, eyes not on the tv but on Catra, her chin props on the shoulder watching closely.

“I feel bad.” Catra replies, and Adora’s eyes widen, and now Adora feels bad because she understands that it’s her fault that Catra feels this way. It’s breaking her, “It’s not your fault. It’s only my parents I can deal with.”

“No. You shouldn’t be dealing with it alone.” Such strong words come out so soft, and light.

“But it’s no-” Catra starts, but is quickly interrupted.

“Not nothing. Love. It’s upsetting you. I want to be here for you, please.” Adora cuts the girl off. Adora squeezes the girl's hand letting her know quickly I'm *here.*

“You’re right. Sorry. It’s my mom, she uh- misses me or something.” Catra is so timit, and soft.

“It’s up to you. Not your mom.” Adora replies, it’s quick.

“I know, but she’s my mom.”

“And? She’s your mom, she has nothing on you.” She’s sensitive when she talks, and it does work on Catra, Catra gets it, and understands what Adora is saying.

“By-” Catra’s cut off again, but she;s fine with that.

“No butting. Your mother should not have control when you're 17, and not living with her.” Adora replies, she squeezes the hand again, and Catra desperately keeps it, she needs it, and agrees that yes she loves the girl. And Adora is right.

“She’s my mom.” She frowns.

“Of course, and I'm not telling you that she isn’t, but she’s hurting you.”

“I know.” Catra replies, she feels bad she’s getting super worked up, and she needs to calm down before the other starts freaking out since she knows that would happen. She’s really struggling to keep herself from freaking.

“Catra.” She hears the blonde replies and it’s foggy and makes her ears ring., “Your heart is racing. Can you please focus on me?” Adora asks so calmly and there.

“Sorry. Sorry. I don’t know what happened. Um- I’m okay.” The tanned girl replies, she seems scared, and confused, but preasten and there.

“Alright..” She replies suspiciously. “You don’t have to be okay.” Adora then comments, now ruffling up her hair.

“I’m okay. It’s just my parents.” Catra seems as if this is normall, and that she doesn’t want to murder her poor parents, who were terrible parents that did not deserve a kid, let alone the right to have a child in the first place.

“You shouldn’t have to go through this. I really wished I could do something.” Adora says, she’s looking at the wall, one hand (that's not deep in Catra’s hair) is clenching in anger, she hates it.

“Adora. Don’t get upset on my behalf. I barely talk to my parents they just get sad about it sometimes.” Catra is saying the truth, since she moved with Adora, she has felt way better, safer, and loved. And Catra’s never really felt love before, so now being drowned in it overwhelms her sometimes. She knows, or thinks that Adora also gets overwhelmed easily when she’s not alone. They both get it.

“It’s hard..” Catra comes up with, knowing that Adora is listening full heartly. And being there.

“Love is.” Adora replies, she knows that Adora didn’t think before she said that, but they both relate to it deeply, and it makes sense.

“Yeah.” The brunette laughs, but it's cold and hard, making the girl feel hurt by it.

“Yup.” She staggers. Strained voice. Adora knows she’s selfish for acting this way, it seems to always be about her.

“I’m sorry.” Catra says. “I’m kinda upset. I’m not too sure why, please don’t ask. I really don’t know why it’s bothering me this time so much.” Catra says again, feeling Adora’s hand squeeze hers.

“Don’t feel sorry about that.” Adora replies. “It’s okay.”

“Can we just relax today?” Catra’s voice quietly drowns out the soft tv white noise.

“Of course.” She says immediately.

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Catra slowly- so very slowly closes things with her parents. She wants them to get clean before she’ll contact them. She thanks Adora gratefully for giving her the strength to stand up to her parents. Right now her, Adora , Lonnie and Kyle, they were in some fancy food place getting dinner. It was somewhat joyfull.

“I think you’ve grown on Lonnie, Catra.” Kyle comments, he uses it elbow hitting Lonnie's rib. They were waiting for the food, all being super hungry and it smelt so amazing in the place.

“Hhpm.” Lonnie sighs, she looks at Catra, death stares in her eyes. But she didn’t deny it.

“You do.” Adora smiles.

“Whatever.” Lonnie grumbles, they can see they’re waiter coming with their food. They were really hungry.

Once they fill their tummies they go back out heading to a small park (the one that Adora and Catra go to all the time.) Kyle sits down in the rocks, Adora next to him. Lonnie and Catra sit on the swings kicking their feet in the water under the swings.

Adora lays down in the rocks, it doesn't feel nice but she's tired. Kyle watches her closely along with the others.

"Why lay in the rocks, they're literally wet, you dumbass." Lonnie says, kicking a few rocks at the laying blonde.

"I'm tired." Adora sighs, and she is saying the truth, last night she was working on some stuff so she didn't get a lot of sleep. Catra knew this.

"Sleep more." Lonnie lags. She walks over from her puddle swing, sitting criss cross in front of the blonde. One of the big indicators that Adora was upset, (in this case tired.) her face gets hot, it always happens in the horde. So they knew, Lonnie reached more close to the blonde then slowly touched her cheek. "Hot." Lonnie looks at Kyle. He nods.

"Guys. Lets go for a walk," Adora replies, and the group nods, and they start walking over to the bridge part of the park, then heading south to the trails.

"Tired." quotes Catra.

“Walking.” Adora replies.

“Y'all don’t act like you are dating, Boring.” Lonnie sighs, watching them too. And Catra knows that it was a target on her, having nothing to do with Adora, all because Lonnie does not like Catra as much, she doesn’t trust her. But maybe Catra is growing on her.

They were never big on PDA, they sometimes would hold hands when they saw the other was stressed, but it was never big and noticeably, they both didn’t even like being touched anyways. (Add on that Adora hates when people look at her so Catra tries to keep the stairs to a minimum.)

“That means Lons.” Adora replies, pouting and cuddling up to Catra.

After their eventful day Adora and Catra were exhausted, both falling asleep so quick in bed. Mara laid beside them, falling asleep as well. They both enjoyed hanging out with Lonnie and Kyle, since Catra would never be caught dead with Glimmer and Bow, to add they’re toxic, and Adora just feels hurt while texting them.

When the girls wake up, Adora almost always wakes up first, she gets up and feeds Mara, also giving her water and love before Catra wakes up. It’s like a routine they have, not too long after Catra will join sitting at the table, waiting for Adora to pour her coffee too.

“Thanks.” Catra mumbles, she’s too tired right now to be nice, Adora as well.

“Mhm.” Adora says she's walking over to scoop up Mara then sitting on the floor petting her. The cat meowls, stretching out and yawning.

A moment passes, and all that is heard is Catra sipping her coffee letting herself wake up, “What are we doing today?” Adora asks, and she’s happy because she actually passed highschool, and is happy. She’s happy.

“What would you like to do?” Catra asks.

“Mh, I’m not sure,” Adora replies, she watches as Mara goes down to her tummy, arms reaching out. “Chill day?” Adora asks.

“Chill day.” Catra smiles, and it’s perfect. They're okay.

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